

Psych 340 The Boy Crisis

Numbered Transcript

PSYC 340 • Dr. Warren Farrell

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Lecture 1: Causes & Consequences

At a glance — Farrell introduces the boy crisis and his background, laying out its causes and consequences — declining outcomes for boys across education, employment, and mental health.

- 1.1 Let me spend a little bit of time giving you a bit of background so you understand where I'm coming from. This is me, actually, with a fellow woman named Gloria Steinem, who you may recognize. And my first days in gender issues were with the board of directors of the National Organization for Women in New York City.
- 1.2 As I got involved with them, they were having a big debate as to whether or not there should be men involved in the national organization for women or not. And the main issue was that every month, they had what they called "consciousness raising" groups, to make women more aware of the degree to which men had a system of patriarchy that was keeping them oppressed and the degree to which they felt they were able to get in touch with the things that were bothering them.
- 1.3 And so the problem was that when men attended these once-per-month meetings, the women felt very inhibited from really opening up and saying what they really felt. And that was, from my perspective, totally understandable. And so they were debating whether to kick men out completely from NOW. And their compromise—I'm always a compromise—the compromise was me. And they said, "Listen, let Warren Farrell form some men's groups and get the men out of the women's hair, and let's see if that works." And so I did do that, and it worked from their perspective.
- 1.4 And I went through two phases in that era. Phase one was getting the men together. And then after they spoke for a minute or two, I'd give them a feminist lecture as to why they were wrong and why a feminist perspective was more accurate and how their consciousness was not raised. And one day, I decided to actually listen, as opposed to telling them a different ideology. And as I started listening, they didn't trust me at first, but eventually they opened up and began telling stories that I sort of resonated with in my own life. And my father's information to me about why I shouldn't be a writer, for example, because a writers rarely find publishers, and if you can't find a publisher, you'll never find a wife. Therefore, just do something that makes money. You're good at math so do math. But then I began to be in touch with my own feelings and sort of more open to what they were really saying and what they were really feeling. And here I was telling them to feel, but I was lecturing to them, which did not draw out their feelings.
- 1.5 And so once I started to do that listening, I began to sort of integrate some of those to my lectures. I was now lecturing all around the world on women's issues and the importance of women's issues, both to women and also to men. But now I started integrating some of the boys' and men's perspectives, or the perspectives of the men and the fathers, and sharing what their son's perspectives were. And as I did that,

instead of expanding my audience, it shrank my audience. My standing ovations went from standing ovations to sitting ovations. My referrals to other speaking engagements—which was my source of income—went from about 4 per speech to down to the 1, then down to 0 to one. And so I began to see the handwriting on the wall. But I also thought it was important to sort of share both sex's perspectives as opposed to just one's.

1.6 And then sort of the straw that broke the camel's back was, I was at a board meeting of the National Organization for Women in New York City, and I started to see the beginning of the evidence—this was the early 70s, and there was already a lot of divorces occurring, that to a much greater degree than in the 60s and the 50s—so I started to see that the first children of divorce were not doing very well, but particularly those children that did not have fathers involved after the divorce. And so I mentioned some of this information to the board members and, total silence.

1.7 And finally, one of the women, one of the braver ones, spoke up and said, "Warren, the National Organization for Women has a lot of issues to deal with. Our feminist members, they want to be able to say, after divorce, 'Let us decide what's right for the children. If we want the father involved, we should have the father involved. If we don't want the father involved, we shouldn't have to have the father involved.' If we force them into sort of this equal, shared parenting stuff that you're talking about, this is going to alienate some members, and that will lose them not only for the custody issues but also for other issues that we want to support." Well, I understood that, but I didn't feel very good about that. And then they also pointed out to me that, "You know, Warren, your source of income comes from almost all feminist referrals. Just let that sink in." And I had already told them that this was just the beginning of the research. And so the "compromise", quote unquote, was for me to go out and do more research before I spoke up. And in fact, I did.

1.8 But the more research I did, the more I began to see that this was not just the beginning of data, I was identifying to them about 5 or 6 ways that boys in particular, but also girls, suffered when they didn't have dad involvement. I was now beginning to accumulate some of the data that eventually led me to identifying more than 50 different ways from suicide to depression, to many of the things that I'll talk about.

1.9 And actually, before I do talk about some of those things in terms of what's statistically true, let me just ask you for a moment, would you close your eyes for a moment with me and just think about people in your neighborhood or your school or in your family that have had problems with both boys and girls. And think about whether there's been more boys affected negatively by a tendency to sort of emotionally withdraw, become addicted to video games, get poorer grades in school, be belligerent, have problems with their own motivation. Raise your hand if some of the boys that you know or know of are more likely to have these problems than girls. Just open your eyes and raise your hand. So I'm seeing actually every hand raised. So 100% of us have seen that. And this,

I'm not just talking about an isolated incident here and there, but about a pattern that is dominant in the culture. And unfortunately, many of us have seen this, but not necessarily seen the complete evidence that surrounds this.

- 1.10** What I'll be sharing with you today is—and tomorrow and the next day—is 3 things. One is the overall evidence for the boy crisis, two, 5 of the most important Causes, and that about a dozen solutions. And those solutions will be at both the personal level, like family dinner nights, and also at the political level, like at the national level, the school level and the local level.
- 1.11** The boy crisis exists both in the United States and globally in the 70 largest developed nations. So I'm going to start with the evidence of the US crisis and then move to the global crisis. Here's a bit of the evidence of the US crisis. You can begin to see that when boys and girls are both 9 years old or under, they both commit suicide very rarely, and they commit suicide at about an equal level. But at the ages of 10-14, boys commit suicide at twice the rate of girls, between the ages of 15-19, at 4 times the rate of girls, and between the ages of 20-24, between about 5, 5 1/2 times the rate of girls. So you can see that something during the years in which boys learn to be boys does not inspire all boys, to say the least.
- 1.12** I'm going to look at the mental health besides suicide for boys, more US military are killed by suicide in 1 year than were killed in the wars in Iraq and Afghanistan in all years combined. And yet you very rarely hear about that. In the mental health area in the United States, there's a huge gap between what happens with teenage boys and teenage girls. Between 5-7 hours of video games per week are actually pretty healthy by most studies. Teenage boys use video games, though, about 13+ hours a week, and that's gone up even more recently. Teenage girls use them about 5 hours a week. So there's a big difference between the video game usage between our sons and our daughters, and here's the implications of that.
- 1.13** Playing video games motivates our brain to win at the game, but it doesn't motivate us to win at life. I'll explain the difference there. Video games have a lot of the stimulus when they're in excess that cocaine has. Playing video games motivates our brain to win at the game, but it doesn't motivate our brain to win at life. And here's the distinction between those two in the brain. Real-life achievements get registered in the dorsolateral prefrontal cortex of the brain. And video game success creates dopamine, and that's a feel-good drug in the nucleus accumbens, part of the brain. And that rewards you for winning at the game, but it doesn't reward you for winning at life. Two different motivators in the brain.
- 1.14** It's one of the reasons why people who are younger, and they really get on a high from winning game after game, and they think that's really increasing their brain's power overall. It is increasing their brain's power in the area that stimulates them to win more games, distinct from what helps them win at life in general. And so that's a huge difference. And it's one of the reasons we see so many kids moving to an addiction level

at video games, but not kids in general, to a much greater degree, boys. By age 21, boys average 14,000 hours of gaming. You can achieve a bachelor's degree in about a third of that time. To me, that's amazing.

1.15 Let's move over from mental health to physical health. In the United States, in just 90 years, the male/female life expectancy gap in the US has increased more than 400%. In 1920, there was only one year difference between male life expectancy and female life expectancy. In 2021, the year from the most recent data, 5.3 year life expectancy gap between males and females. Male life expectancy is decreasing before COVID which is the only fair time to measure life expectancy for obvious reasons. Three years before COVID male life expectancy went down three years in a row. That's an historical first for non-COVID, non-war era. But female life expectancy did not. Obviously, no one wants female life expectancy to decrease, but we also don't want male life expectancy to decrease, especially three years in a row. That's when it really shows a pattern that is problematic.

1.16 Boys today have sperm counts less than half of what their grandfathers had at their age. And of course, that affects the fertility and the health and vitality of female children. This is really a good example of the impact of either sex having problems. If you have the sperm counts of males going down, that affects female children as well as male children. And it's really a perfect metaphor for what happens when we're all in the same family boat. When it appears that only one sex loses, obviously both sexes lose.

1.17 For the first time in us history, our sons will have less education than their dads. Take a look here at bachelor's degrees. Notice that on the upper left hand side, you see a male figure, the bachelor degrees. In 1969, boys got 57% of bachelor's degrees. Girls or women got 43%. In 2020, the trend has reversed. Boys get 42% of bachelor's degrees, women, 58%. It's projected that in a few years, the ratio of female to male bachelor's degrees will become 2:1. One of the reasons for that is that boys get admitted to college at a certain rate, but drop out 10% more frequently than girls do. So you add the fewer admissions together with the greater failure in school during college. Despite affirmative action programs now beginning to go in the direction of males getting them into college, the males are still dropping out at a faster rate. There are today more than 2.8 million more women than men with postsecondary school degrees—2.8 million difference.

1.18 So let's look at the implications of that for families. Female graduates are rarely on the lookout for future fathers who are dropouts. Female graduates do not tend to be highly attracted to male dropouts, and yet, there are 2.8 million more women either competing for this much smaller group of men or saying, "I can't take it. I'm going to be a single mom." So we see the single mom data, and this is one of the reasons for that single mom data. So let's look at the whole picture here. As for male high school dropouts, more than 20% of male high school dropouts—which are much more

common among young men than women—more than 20% of them are unemployed in their 20s. So imagine a woman who's a college graduate wanting to have a future husband who's about her equal looking around for a future husband. She has those considerations.

- 1.19** And she also has another consideration. Boys today are 66% of the people likely to live back with their parents, usually in their parents' basements. So imagine this female walking around with a sign saying, "Looking for a future husband, please," and she searches unemployment lines, "Well, maybe not." Then she searches parents' basements and she puts, "Any dropouts in here?" It's not a likely scenario for a female to feel inspired. And again, it's an example of the lose-lose situation. Boys and men appear to be the losers, and yes, they are. But there are also girls and women who are looking for responsible, talented, intelligent, equally educated males to be the fathers of their children. And they can't find them either.
- 1.20** And so it's another example—when either sex loses, both sexes lose. So, in brief, you have fewer bachelor's degrees and more bachelors. And here's the trend. We have a nation of single moms, and we have a nation of single men who are lonely and without purpose. We have a nation of children who are dad-deprived. So that's 3 groups, but there's actually 4 lose-lose-lose situations— men, women, children, and our nation.
- 1.21** Let's look at IQs for a moment. Boys who are nearly 12 years old today are doing only as well as the 8 -9-year-old boys in the 70s on their IQ tests. We'll see that this is not just in the United States, but I'll get to this data globally as well. So let me switch over to the evidence for a global crisis.
- 1.22** All around the world, they have terms that imply a boy crisis. In China, it's women up, men down, in Japan, it's herbivores or socially isolated, in a good part of Europe, it's an acronym called NEET, which is Not in Education, Employment, or Training, and in Sweden recently, they identified it as the boy crisis—I don't know whether my book had any impact or not, but I'll make believe it did. In India, the male suicide rate in India is growing more than 9 times that of the female suicide rate, 37% male versus 4% female since the year 2000. In the UK in 2015, more men died by suicide than all British soldiers fighting in all wars since 1945.
- 1.23** Part of the amazing part of this data is the data. Another part is that almost nobody has heard of this before. If these things were happening to girls and women, it would be all over the news and we'd all be really aware of it, and we all should be really aware of it, because nobody would want this to be happening to girls and women. The research published in the medical journal Lancet—which you've probably all heard of— says "Suicide now takes more lives than war, murder, and natural disasters combined, stealing more than 36 million years of healthy life around the world." The evidence on the global level that's physical, "If male and female mortality rates were equal, it would save more lives than curing cancer." The results of a 20-country study concluded this

data about "female and male mortality rates saving more lives than curing cancer if they were both equal."

- 1.24** Boys today have sperm counts less than half of what their grandfathers had at their age. Notice that this is global, as well as what we all already saw being US sperm counts. The UN finds that boys have fallen behind girls in every one of 70 of the largest developed nations, especially in reading and writing—and as you probably all know, reading and writing are the single biggest predictors of academic success or failure. They're not the biggest predictors of life success or failure. The biggest predictors of life success or failure is postponed gratification. But the biggest predictor of academic success or failure is the ability to read and write, and that's also a big predictor of life success or failure.
- 1.25** Note that the US is last among 31 nations when comparing the decline in degree attainment of males between the ages of 25-34 versus the generation before ages 55-64. Here's the big discovery about IQs. Usually, IQs go up about ten points per generation in the almost 2 generations since 1980, that would predict IQs on average going up about 20 points. But instead, boys IQs have dropped 15 points since the 1980s. So if you add those 20 points to the 15 points, you have almost 35 point loss of potential IQ as a result of the dynamics that we'll be discussing that has led to the boy crisis. What a loss for not just boys, but for everybody that interacts with boys.
- 1.26** So I'd like to get now into some of the causes for this. I want to say first that there's a lot of causes to the boy crisis. And I was tempted to go with a lot of the causes that we all sort of see identified around us—causes such as a lack of male teachers, there's a cutting back on recess, there's a cutting back on vocational education. These causes have been out there in the media, but they're not the real causes; they are the symptoms. What I want to deal with, with this group, is the underlying causes that are creating these symptoms. So we can really deal with it at that deeper level.
- 1.27** And one of those causes we've already touched on briefly, which is a half-century of belief that girls and women were powerless and that boys and men had the power, that boys and men were part of a patriarchy which made rules to benefit men at the expense of women, that masculinity was basically toxic, that males already had male privilege, that males already have male power. And so if we don't understand the paradox of male power, the coexistence of power in the way we define it—as being at the top of a ladder and powerlessness inside of oneself—that all makes sense.
- 1.28** But what also makes sense is something much deeper that's been happening in the last 50 years. And that is when somebody says that boys and men are having problems, the assumption is twofold. One is, "Well, they're having problems now, but eventually boys become men, and they don't seem to have problems, then they have all the power, the privilege, and the inheritance of male patriarchy. So why pay attention to them? And if you are persisting on paying attention to them, maybe it's because you don't understand all the problems of being oppressed that females have, and therefore,

maybe you're misogynist. So better shut your mouth. And if you try to explain, you're mansplaining."

- 1.29** And so a toxic atmosphere has been happening that's preventing people from even speaking up about what might be a problem in the back of your mind. And you saw the problems that I had when I began to articulate boys and men's issues. When I was speaking around the world as a feminist, it was the loss of somewhere between \$10-\$22 million worth of income over my lifetime. So it's a choice. And most people are having to support children.
- 1.30** They're in a community that if they already think that boys and men are the problem and girls and women are the result of that problem, they feel hesitant about speaking up because it doesn't just mean them not having the courage to speak up. It means a potential loss of job, it means a potential loss of respect from spouse, it means a potential loss of income from children, and we're all attracted to the dopamine that gets stimulated in our brain when we get approval from others. So it's very challenging for us to have a social group that we get a lot of approval from, love, from, promotions from, respect from, and then to begin to challenge the underlying ideology, whether you're on the political left or political right or no matter what you believe, it's very challenging to go against that.
- 1.31** And if we are really going to solve the problems of the future, we all have to listen to each other a lot better than we've been doing now, which is why I've been spending the last 30 years of my life doing a lot of couples communication courses, because I see that as the beginning of the way to teach people who differ to hear each other, to be able to be detectives who see a piece of the other person's puzzle and then ask—instead of arguing about that piece—say, "Tell me more about another piece in the puzzle. Another piece in the puzzle. Another piece of the puzzle." Until we see their entire picture. We can still disagree with the way their picture looks to us, and we need to have our chance to talk, but we need to not be stymied by our belief that if we hear them, that means we agree with them, and therefore, we're evil, like they are.
- 1.32** So I'm going to deal with 5 underlying Causes of the Boy Crisis. One is dad-deprived boys. The second is the one that I've just been referring to, this half-century of belief that girls and women are powerless and males have male toxicity, male privilege, male power, and we're the oppressors that are born out of the patriarchy that made rules to benefit men at the expense of women. Third is the purpose void. Fourth is the fear of psychological attachment to someone that we may lose. And fifth is our repulsion for males who complain—how deeply that's built into all of our psyches.
- 1.33** So I'll start out first with dad-deprived boys. When I submitted my proposal to my publisher for The Boy Crisis book, I identified about a dozen causes, potential causes of the boy crisis, and I proposed that I would study each of them about equally, but the more I studied them, the more I saw that, well, for example: Male teachers, lack of male teachers, that was a problem. But it was mostly a problem only when a boy came

from a female-only home and then went to a school with female-only teachers and had no male role model, either at home or at school, to be a constructive male role model.

- 1.34** So everybody wants to belong. And boys like that, they often felt that they became attracted to a gang that said, "Be part of us. We'll give you reputation. We'll give you family." Or that they were so unmotivated, they produced very little in terms of income. They weren't able to buy the car. They weren't able to do things to attract girls. And so they ended up being attracted by dealing drugs, by which they could make about ten times what they made flipping hamburgers. That, for an unmotivated boy, seemed really tempting. Plus, dealing drugs, you're part of that drug dealing community, and so you feel like you have family.
- 1.35** But boys who grew up with fathers and involved and loving fathers didn't make much difference statistically whether they had many male teachers or not, or even any male teachers, because they had the involvement of their dad at home. And all the things that we'll be talking about in a little while that dads do. It was nice for them to have male teachers, but it wasn't crucial for them to have male teachers. So we'll be looking at that issue.
- 1.36** So if I were to summarize what I discovered as the single most important of many of causes of the boy crisis, I would say that the boy crisis, more than anything else, the boy crisis resides where dads do not reside. And so what's to me is fascinating about this is why? Why has this happened? Do you remember when I mentioned in the last section about evidence? I talked about the UN's finding that boys have fallen behind girls in every one of the 70 largest developed nations. You probably hung on the word "70". Now, I'd like you to switch your psyche to the word "developed".
- 1.37** In developed nations, something happens. There's enough people in the citizenry who have survival mastered that the government no longer has to prohibit divorces. And there doesn't need to be social pressure on women to be married before they have children. There's less shaming of single moms and there's less shaming of people for getting divorces. The challenge here is this: the divorces often lead to fights between moms and dads who disappears? Most frequently the dad disappears. Not always, but when he does, not because the dad disappears necessarily, many, many men fight to be more involved with their children. When, for whatever reason, without focus on blame that the children do lose their dad, that tends to have a huge impact on the benefits or the lack of benefits among the children. The boys tend to get depressed and tend to move into many problems that we'll explore in a few minutes.
- 1.38** The second thing is, single moms. Notice here the last two columns. In 1960, the percentage of single moms was 5%. Most recent data, 41% in the United States. You can see that most dramatically by looking at the right two columns.
- 1.39** Want to be clear before I move on, that from my perspective, I was married for a number of years, and then I met the woman who became my wife about 30 years ago.

And between those marriages, I started dating women. But I found that the women who were women, as opposed to girls, were women who had children. And so I started dating women who had children. And almost every single mother that I dated used one word as much as the word love, which is the word overwhelmed. She often felt also guilty that she was not doing as well as she could at work compared to what she knew was inside of her, capability wise, and simultaneously was not doing the best she could for her children because she felt a constant pressure juggling act and being, as I said, overwhelmed. So I want to really acknowledge that.

1.40 And I also want to say that the majority of boys—and this is very important—the majority of boys raised by single moms do well. So when you're looking at the boy crisis, you're not looking at what automatically happens when boys don't have fathers. The majority of boys raised by single moms do well psychologically, financially, and in terms of education. Two examples of that—whether you agree with the policies or not—two examples of that particular issues are President Clinton and Obama. They both were dad-deprived boys. Obama had a very involved grandfather, but nevertheless, his biological dad was pretty absent. He wrote a book on that, and he describes to this day the hole in his heart that he still feels from the lack of dad involvement. But what must be said about both Obama and Clinton is that they were both motivated and they both get higher speaking fees than I get.

1.41 Among those boys caught in the boy crisis— I want to read a letter to you that is the most tragic letter that Jordan Peterson and I have talked about quite a bit, and I've tried to help this boy who wrote this letter to me. I'll share a little bit about our efforts, but this is a tragic letter, the most tragic letter I've ever received. But it tells so much in a short period that I want to share this with you. "Dr. Farrell. My mother was a feminist when she was young and chose to be a single mother voluntarily. Not having a father, left a void in my life and a hole in my heart. The Boy Crisis described my life so accurately, that if I didn't know better, I'd have thought you were spying on me. Growing up, I was not motivated to be involved with my peers, and my mother never pushed me to excel in academics. I developed an addiction to video games, which facilitated a life of increasing dysfunction and isolation that ended up with me being a recluse. I also developed a porn addiction due to not having a traditional outlet to release my sexual tension as a teenager. All of this was exacerbated by being socially ostracized and having frequent intense and vicious arguments with my mother. I was still living in my mother's basement and got heavily involved with 4chan and 8chan."

1.42 "I became involved, that is, with neo fascist ideologies and I was active within the incel community as well. I actually interacted briefly with the Aztec High School shooter through my contacts in the neo fascist community. And I myself had written a 52- page manifesto outlining my plans to do a mass shooting. I slowly began to realize something was seriously wrong and my mental health had deteriorated dramatically as well. The Boy Crisis helped make sense of why I became who I was, and it was like waking up

from a coma. I decided to go get help and have recently been diagnosed with schizotypal personality disorder. I've slowly been making progress at getting my life together. If it was not for you, sir, I think I would have eventually acted out on the beliefs expressed in my manifesto, as others that I worked with did in 8chan, such as the El Paso shooter Patrick Crusius, or the Christchurch, New Zealand shooter Brenton Tarrant had. So I want to personally thank you because I feel like you have saved not only my life, but potentially the lives of other innocent people. Sincerely, Carlos."

1.43 So I decided that I had a responsibility to work with him a bit. And so I called up the president of the president elect at the time of Division 51 of the American Psychological Association, who was Daniel Ellenberg. And he and I worked together and sent the letter off to Jordan Peterson, and Jordan had a lot of very helpful comments. And among the three of us, we tried to do something to work with this boy. I'd like to say that we created miracles. We did not. We made progress. Yes, I think we did. But he's not out of the hole yet. I think he has promised me over and over again that he would never act on the mass shooting, but he still has enormous psychological problems that he's dealing with to this day. But it is such a sad and tragic summary of so much of what happens in exaggerated form. Fortunately for most boys that are dad-deprived, it does not get taken this far.

1.44 That's one example of the impact of lack of dad involvement. But then looking at some of the reasons for it, let's look at some of the discrimination that dads experience. So when dads do want to be involved with children, what is the psychological atmosphere that exists that allows something like this to happen? This is a boy, obviously, "When I grow up, I will beat my wife." It's really hard to believe—I'm going to read you the subscript first because it's a little hard to read—the subscript says, "Girls who grew up in households with domestic violence are more likely to end up with abusive partners. Break the cycle of domestic violence." Now, here's the fascinating thing about this picture. This is on the Dallas Area Transit, and in order to get something up on the Dallas Area Rapid Transit, it would have to go through about a dozen layers of bureaucracy before it gets up there like this that anyone who's worked with the government knows. And so it means that at every level of bureaucracy, there was approval for this ad going up saying, "When I grow up, I will beat my wife."

1.45 Can you imagine a boy looking at this, or could you imagine the ad being reversed?—Any of you who have read any of the work that I've done on domestic violence know that domestic violence is, unfortunately, an equal opportunity offender. Both girls and boys hit each other about equally at every level of violence, including the killing level. But that's a more complex one to explain. So I'm not going to get into the data on that now—but we could imagine a girl saying, "When I grow up, I will beat my husband," being featured on this. And imagine somebody suggesting this as the advertisement for the Dallas Area Rapid Transit and how fast that person would be seen as a misogynist and therefore it wouldn't get anywhere. It's not the existence of this ad that is as

important as the multiple levels of bureaucracy that reflect the attitude and the culture that would allow this ad to go through all of those unchecked and then have that appear as a government sponsored phenomenon.

- 1.46 Another example, the same group, "One day my husband will kill me." Now, with domestic violence being about equal and men and women killing each other differently, that leads to the overt statistic saying, more men kill women than women kill men. But the difference in the way men and women kill leads to data that shows that men and women kill each other about equally as well. And so without getting into the complexity of that data, could you imagine there being a boy here saying, "One day my wife will kill me"? So this is part of the atmosphere that has led to discrimination against dads, that has led to the boy crisis.
- 1.47 Let's look this at something even more amazing, which is the Moynihan Report. In 1965—raise your hand if you've heard of Daniel Patrick Moynihan, senator—there was a fellow named Daniel Patrick Moynihan who was both a US senator, he had a PhD in sociology, he worked under, as secretary of labor, under both presidents Nixon and Lyndon Johnson. Because he was so respected at both sides of the aisle, he was asked to do something that just in popular culture became called the Moynihan Report. That came out in 1965. He was asked to study inner city violence and the causes of inner city violence. And if it wasn't somebody who was so respected, people were going, "Wait a minute, we know that inner city violence is often caused by black people. Is this going to be really racist? And is this really going to be anti black?" And so on. And he got the freedom, though, to just study it. What he discovered was something very different than racism.
- 1.48 He discovered that there was more violence, inner city wise, caused by those 25% of males who were black who were dad-deprived, not the other 75% who were not dad-deprived. At that point in time, 1965, only 3.2% of caucasian males were dad-deprived. That's 1965. Today, among caucasian males, the percentage of dad-deprived is 36%. That is about 40% higher than the statistic for black males being dad-deprived in 1965. So Caucasians have already exceeded the figure that led Moynihan to see, this is the problem that causes inner city violence more than any other. And obviously, when you're studying percentages, it doesn't, because the percentages in a certain direction doesn't mean it applies in every case.
- 1.49 Second, among black males today, the figure is no longer 25% of black males dad-deprived, but 72%. So you can get a sense of, we've often been focusing on, in the back of our minds, maybe a racist idea, or we've been focusing on other solutions—we need to give more welfare money, we need to give more better schooling, better education. But almost all over, when you see the data, including some new books that have come out on boys issues, they keep saying, we don't know the reason for this. And yet the reason for this has been apparent to us since 1965. We're just unwilling to hear the

reason for this. And I'll get to why we're unwilling to hear the reason for this in a little while as well.

- 1.50** What happens when males are dad-deprived is that there's a loss, oftentimes among boys, but also among girls. Everything that happens to boys, with a couple of exceptions, also happens to girls who are dad-deprived. The difference is they happen to boys more frequently and more intensely. More than 50 different metrics that lead to a parent's nightmare about what a child is going through are true for both girls and for boys. It's just more intensely and more frequently the case with boys.
- 1.51** I mentioned before postponed gratification. Boys who are dad-deprived, as a rule, are much more likely to not have postponed gratification. They're much less likely to be empathetic. They're much less likely to have social skills. They're much less likely to be motivated. They're more likely to be depressed, commit suicide, and have problems with their identity. This is just a few of the 50 ways. They're more likely to have ADHD, more likely to be obese, and many, many other of those ways. They're also much more likely to be addicted to alcohol, to drugs, to video games, and to porn. Since 1960, they're also far more likely to be imprisoned. And since 1980, California has built 23 prisons and 4 universities. Women have women's centers, and men also have men's centers. They're called prisons. Prisons are basically centers for dad-deprived boys.
- 1.52** Some years ago, against Schwarzenegger, I ran for governor of California. And when I did, I spoke at a number of different prison populations. Fortunately, I asked this at the first prison I spoke with, I said, "How many of you are dad-deprived?" I explained what dad-deprived meant. And about 85% to 95% were the averages in the prisons. And the prison guards never asked that question before. The people in the prison, the administrative staff, the grant fundraisers and so on, had never even noticed that.
- 1.53** And so I began to talk about what dads contribute to children doing better in life. I had lineups of prisoners after my presentation waiting to speak to me. I remember one guy who's just a perfect example. He had muscles like I'll never have and tattoos, and he was really trying to repress his tears. And finally, he asked me if I would have the other men step back so they wouldn't see him talk to me. And he, "Dr. Farrell, I always thought I was a loser, that I was here because I deserve being here. I never realized how much I could contribute to my children not making the mistakes that I made being here. I am so motivated now to shorten my term in prison, to get out and help my children before they lose the ability to ever be helped by me." That was the story I heard again and again from people who seemed, who self described themselves as losers, who thought they were worthless, they were without purpose, they weren't needed, they were just a bother to people. When they saw that they could contribute something, that they could be needed, that they had something unique to contribute that I'll talk about soon. That's when they sort of turned around psychologically. Made a huge impact on me.

- 1.54** In prison, a lot of ugly things happen we all know about male rapes in prison that actually totally exceed male heterosexual rapes outside of prison, and just the humiliations that are often seen as very appropriate for prisoners to go through. There is a 700% increase in the prison population since 1972, up until 2013. And it's leveled off fortunately, since 2013. What dad-deprived boys miss is a lot of things. I'll be sharing a few of those things here.
- 1.55** One of the differences between dad-style parenting and mom-style parenting is roughhousing. And so let's say the dad has three children and two of them are boys and one is a girl let's say. A dad will typically do something like, "Okay, kids, let's do some roughhousing." The kids will go, "All right!" "I'll take the three of you and put the three of you on the couch. And here's the game. The three of you jump off the couch, get onto my back, and the game is you see who can pin me down faster than I can pin all three of you down. I have to pin all three of you down. It's kind of unfair, but see if you can pin me down first." "All right, dad. All right, dad."
- 1.56** Meantime, Mom's looking on and going, "Oh, my God. I feel like I have just one more child to monitor." On the other hand, the mom doesn't want to interfere. She doesn't want to be controlling. She sees the kids are having fun. But there's a part of her that feels like, "I just feel like, intuitively, I feel like sooner or later, somebody's going to get hurt." The mom is only about 99% likely to be right. Sooner or later, somebody gets hurt. And so when that happens, then Mom starts feeling guilty, like, "I knew this. I knew this intuitively. Why didn't I pay attention to my intuition and stop this before one of the kids got hurt? That's not right. Dads are so, my husband is so dense. But all right, at least I wasn't controlling. And now at least he'll see from real life experience that somebody got hurt, so he won't do this anymore"—Not.
- 1.57** Dad instead goes ahead and says, "Okay, Jimmy, you took your elbow and you put your elbow in your sister's face. You cannot do that as a way of winning at roughhousing." "Okay, Dad. Okay, Dad, I got it. I got it." Mom's going, "No, you're not going to let them go back to the roughhousing that you just learned, led to one of the children being hurt." And sure enough, Dad goes back to the roughhousing and the children, rather than pay attention to Dad, they get caught up in all the emotional excitement of winning again, forget completely what Dad said and go ahead and doesn't actually stick the elbow in his sister's eye, but this time does something else that's too aggressive and not assertive.
- 1.58** And Dad stops the roughhousing and says, "What you did was not putting your elbow in your sister's eye, but what you did was aggressive. That's different than being assertive." "What do you mean aggressive versus assertive?" "I think you exactly experience what aggressive was. And you know what assertive is, not so strong like that." "Okay, Dad." "So now, because I warned you, and you didn't do it this time, there's no more roughhousing tonight." "Oh, Dad, Dad, now we understand. Now we'll do it." "Nope, that's the end. No roughhousing tonight. What will happen is in a few

days when you do things like your homework and things like that, get everything together, if you're on track, all three of you, not any one of you off track, we'll maybe have the roughhousing on Wednesday night rather than tonight, Sunday." "Okay, Dad." And they really look forward to it between then and Wednesday.

- 1.59** And they start really paying much more careful attention and doing what they have to do in order not to lose the privilege because Dad will be more likely to say something like, "If any one of you doesn't do this, all three of you are punished by not having the roughhousing." And Mom in the meantime was looking on, "Wait a minute, twice you've seen that somebody got hurt and you still are not paying attention to the signals. What do I have to do to help you realize that when you do the roughhousing like that, somebody's going to get hurt?" Well, the next time maybe the Wednesday comes and they continue the roughhousing. And this time Dad says, "You know the rules." "Okay, Dad, we got it." But this time, as they're tempted to push the other one aside, be aggressive rather than assertive, stick their elbow in somebody's eye, they realize that if they do that, they are going to lose the roughhousing. And so they're now beginning to learn postponed gratification and empathy.
- 1.60** Okay, let's take empathy first. They're now learning that their sisters and brothers have needs and that they are required to pay attention to those needs if they are going to get what they want—the roughhousing. And so the beginning of empathy develops. And studies show that dads, that rough house, and mostly this way, not all dads do it as well, but the dads who rough house their children are more likely to be empathetic. Again not because Dad is saying, "Be empathetic," but because the children are losing what they want if they don't think of somebody else's needs besides theirs.
- 1.61** The children are also learning that, "I really do want—if you and I are brothers—I really do want to push you out of the way to win, but I have to learn postponed gratification. Not because Dad teaches me postpone gratification and says I have to learn it"—those words are too big to learn anyway—" but because I don't get what I want—roughhousing—unless I think of something other than what I want immediately. I want to get what I want in the long run, the roughhousing is more important than just pushing my brother and sister aside and then losing the roughhousing. And how do I know I'm going to lose the roughhousing? Because the last time I didn't do this, I lost the roughhousing."
- 1.62** Moms are very likely to also say the same types of rules, but when the children break the rules, the moms are more likely to repeat the rules. That's boundary setting. Dads are more likely to be what some people consider cruel, and that is to enforce the boundaries after they've warned the child once or at the most twice. And the parents—obviously any mom can do the same thing, do boundary enforcement—the parents who do boundary enforcement are far more likely to have children that cry at first, but then learn that they don't get what they really want unless they do what is required of them. And they start doing what is required of them.

- 1.63 So the dynamics lead to an increase in empathy, and it also leads to an increase in the father-children bond, from the bond of, "Dad's a lot of fun. We can have a lot of fun with him. I want to do this again. I want to have more fun with him." Dads can then take that bond and begin to extract things that they want from the children, that lead to the children being better children, that otherwise would be seen as criticism, as opposed to dad helping us become a winner.
- 1.64 And so when I used to be raising children, oftentimes—and also when I was a camp counselor—if I would kick a goal through to a boy and I would win in playing soccer when he didn't work hard enough, and I wanted to teach him a lesson by winning—which I would restrain myself from doing when he was working hard—the boy would see me as training him to become a winner. But when I was raising daughters, the daughters needed to learn that that was helping them become a winner because they didn't naturally see that I was helping them become a winner. They thought that I was defeating them and that they felt defeated. And so they had to redo their psychology around what the bond could lead to in terms of helping them win. So—the bond, the postponed gratification, the empathy.
- 1.65 Also, notice—I was saying before—the father was asking the child to distinguish between being assertive versus aggressive. Well, children who learn that distinction are much more likely to have friends in school. When children have friends in school, that increases their dopamine from children for their peers approving of them. So the friends in school motivates them to get approval from my group, who are now more likely to be groups of winners who have also learned postponed gratification. So they move into more highly motivated friends, who then motivate them to produce more, because producing more is rewarded as opposed to put down and mocked. And so all of these things happen from the bond, the empathy, the postponed gratification, the understanding of the differences between being assertive versus aggressive. These are part of what is the bond that dads create. And the important thing about this is that no one is explaining this to anyone. And I do not blame moms for not understanding this because moms can't hear what dads don't say.
- 1.66 I also don't blame dads for not saying this because one of the reasons I wrote about these distinctions in The Boy Crisis book was because I couldn't find them anywhere. I couldn't find them in magazines and books. And so I started seeing these distinctions, and when I shared them, that rang true for many parents. And so I started putting them in writing, and then that allowed parents to be able to say, "Oh, wait a minute, Dad is not just roughhousing in a sort of careless type of way that's going to lead to the children being hurt. This actually creates all these outcomes, on average, that are beneficial to the children." I don't blame dads for not explaining this to moms because dads had nowhere to read this either. And without any context of this, most dads don't say, "I want to rough house with the kids so they'll develop greater empathy." Like

what? What could be more counterintuitive than empathy developing from roughhousing?

- 1.67 And so this, by not being part of the cultural awareness, is leading to so many children being hurt, not having this bond, not having the postponed gratification, not having this distinction between being assertive and aggressive that has been hurting both children, and also the potential for dad involvement because when a dad goes to court to fight for the children, no judge understands this either. And so this is the price of this cultural absence of empathy and knowledge about the importance of dads. Thank you.

Lecture 2: Parenting and Gender Issues

At a glance — On parenting and gender: the difference between boundary setting and boundary enforcement, and the distinct roles mothers and fathers tend to play.

- 2.1** I was mentioning before boundary enforcement and distinguishing that from boundary setting. Moms are very good at setting boundaries, and dads tend to be a little bit better at boundary enforcement. The important thing about what I'm going to be sharing now is that any mom can learn boundary enforcement. It just doesn't instinctively come easily for a more protective instinct where she feels—it's oftentimes really as she sees the child cry, get upset—it feels like she moves from wanting to enforce the boundary to wanting to give the child one more chance. And it's an outcome of empathy, which is very understandable, and it has its place.
- 2.2** And we'll be talking about where it has its place when I talk later about Checks-and-Balance parenting and the importance of seeing the value of what Mom brings to the parenting process and the value of what dads bring to the parenting process and how to negotiate a win-win situation and then how to do that in front of your children, so your children don't see that every difference between mom and dad is an argument, but it becomes a way of solving a problem that they can bring to their children. So that's the framework here for boundary enforcement versus boundary setting.
- 2.3** Here's some of the data on this: setting of bedtimes when moms are in charge of the children versus dads versus the time the children actually get to bed, when moms versus dads are supervising the children. So when moms are supervising the children, raise your hand if you think the bedtimes that are set are earlier. Raise your hand if you think that the bedtimes that are set are later. You all got it right. Moms tend to set earlier bedtimes for the children. Dads tend to set later bedtimes. So on the surface, it would appear that the data would show that dads are more lenient than moms are. Can you guess under whose supervision did the children actually get to bed earlier? Yes, you're saying you're correct. It is with dads. And so what's the dynamic there that leads to the children getting to bed earlier with dads, even though the bedtimes are set earlier by moms?
- 2.4** And here's an example of the this is from the study of actual, this is an actual study of when children get to bed versus when the bedtimes are set. Let's say mom says the bedtime should be 8:30, dad says 9:00. So the 8:30 time comes around and the boy or girl might say to Mom, "Oh my God, I didn't finish homework, and you don't want me to go to school without having finished my homework, do you?" And Mom says, "Well, you did play video games quite a bit, and I did warn you that if you played the video games and didn't stop, that you probably wouldn't get your homework done, and you sort of ignored me. And I did warn you about that once before, but I don't want you to go to school without having your homework done. I know that would be bad." And so

the boy says, "Okay." Or the girl says, "Okay," and then gets time to sort of prepare the homework.

- 2.5** And then at the end of preparing the homework, the boy or the girl says, "Mom, I did the homework like you said I should. Could you read me my favorite story?" And so Mom feels, well, now she or he has done the homework like I asked. Very good. I don't want to punish. I want a reward. And so Mom says, "Okay, your favorite story." And then, "Oh, could you read the other favorite story?" And now Mom feels really good. She doesn't say, you can have a second favorite story. She puts her foot down, so to speak, or whatever you call it, and she stops at that point. So from her perspective, oftentimes that's boundary enforcement.
- 2.6** But the child goes to the dad. The same type of situation happens. The child doesn't finish the homework. The child's been playing some video games or whatever. And Dad says, "Remember last time you were doing that and you didn't get your homework done? I gave you an opportunity last time to finish your homework, but I said, that's going to be the last time this time. And you didn't pay attention to that warning. You have two choices. One is you can go into school tomorrow with your homework not being done, or you can get up early. You can set an alarm, get up early and then do your homework early." "I don't want to get up early, dad." You made the choice. You can go to school without the homework being done, too." "I don't want to do that. I'll be sort of like, that's not good."
- 2.7** So the same basic rule was set by both parents, but Dad is saying, "Sorry, you had your warning, but the warning's up. You chose not to obey it, and now you pay the price." Now, let's say Dad and Mom are in a divorce situation and Dad has custody of children part of the time, mom, another part. And so Mom says, "How were things at your dad's?" "It was terrible I was forced to go to school without doing my homework. Dad wouldn't let me do my homework."— Child's version. And so now to the mom, it appears that A: dad is insensitive, dad is an irresponsible parent, dad is letting the child go to school without doing the homework.
- 2.8** And this is one of the problems when both parents aren't communicating about what really is happening and when there's an underlying assumption that the other parent is the worst parent, and therefore I would serve the child well by protecting the child from the other parent. So from a logical perspective, or from a child's only perspective, this seems like a reasonably decent assumption, but unfortunately, we all see the flaw in that. But it's a good example of the difference between boundary enforcement and boundary setting. And the repeating of the boundaries is the boundary setting. The one repetition of the boundary followed by enforcing the boundary is usually the right combination of boundary setting versus boundary enforcement. So this is what boys miss when they miss their dads.
- 2.9** Another area of risk is risk-taking. Now this type of risk-taking portrayed here is actually a good combination of mom and dad risk-taking. Why? Because it's supervised. There's

a rope, there's a safety valve. The child is taking risks, but there's no chance of the child really, or virtually no chance of the child being significantly hurt. And so usually dads and moms can both agree on this type of risk-taking. It's when it comes to a different type of risk-taking that isn't controlled, that we have a big difference between mom permission for risk-taking and dad permission for risk-taking.

- 2.10** So, for example, climbing a tree in the backyard, mom and dad, the child might go to the mom and say, "Can I climb the tree in the backyard?" And a mom's typical answer might be— if the tree was a big tree and the child was too young—the mom might say, some version of, "You can climb the tree in the backyard in a few years, but not now. You're too young. You could fall and you could get a concussion, or you could break your arm or leg or even be killed."
- 2.11** And dads might say, "Well, the tree is a bit big, so be really careful. Okay?" "Okay, I'll be really careful." And then Dad might occasionally keep an eye on what's happening out there, but also occasionally might not keep an eye on what's happening out there. And so when dad and mom communicate together, there's a potential for dad and mom saying, "Yes, that is a risky situation." And so a checks and balance parenting example would be mom saying, "Well, the child can climb the tree, but not above a certain point, and only if you're standing underneath the tree. To make sure that if the child does fall or a branch does break, that you can then cushion the child from getting a really serious injury.
- 2.12** And by the way, let me have your cell phone so you don't get distracted by the cell phone while you're watching the child climb the tree." And so that might be a good example of dad and mom negotiating that type of thing. But what doesn't happen in that discussion is dads saying something like, "When children climb trees and take risks like this, their IQ gets increased. Why? Because their brain is being called upon to constantly develop new synapses and new neuron connections about what's safe and what's not safe. And so the child has to constantly calculate what's safe and what's not safe." But dads don't tell moms. Dads don't read the books that lead to them being able to say it's really healthy on an intelligence level and a confidence-building level to have that constant observation of what can create a problem and what could not create a problem.
- 2.13** And so without that information, again, moms can't hear what dads don't say, and dads can't hear what they can't read in men's magazines, parenting magazines, parenting books. Dads don't read it that many of them, but even when they do, those answers are not there. And that's why I felt it was so important to not only have the differences between Dad and Mom-style parenting, but what dads don't know about how these things that they tend to do unconsciously lead to outcomes that they don't even know that they're leading to. They do it really from their gut without, again, knowing that. And so that's a good example of, I think, the risk-taking in more typical form and as

opposed to risk-taking in supervised form, but risk-taking in supervised form like this is really a helpful build-up to risk-taking in a more unstructured environment.

- 2.14** Another propensity of dads is to get involved with nature. And on the surface, being involved with nature looks very, just like you take the kids out for camping and you get them involved and enjoy nature. Most people feel that that's a positive. But what very few people articulate, usually being out in nature one-on-one with your child, creates a bonding opportunity. And the children, for whatever reason, tend to feel more open when they're on a one-to-one walk with a parent than they do under normal circumstances at home, especially when there's an opportunity to sort of, like, turn on a video game instead of listening to your parent or go to TikTok or whatever, or check out a friend, or you hear the little ding on the iPhone, and "I've got to check that out right away - life will end if I don't." And so that tends to be really very interfering with a bond being built.
- 2.15** In nature, especially if the parents do enough boundary enforcement to say, "We're going to go on a trip, and we're going to do camping, and we're going to have a lot of fun, and you can help cook the food and stuff like that. And remember, last time we did it, you loved it?" "Yes." "Okay. But we do need to leave the electronics behind, or at least leave them behind for X or Y amount of time to get the children a little bit off, wean them from the addiction. And so once the kids are in that sort of mode of being in nature with Mom or with Dad or with the family, and nature works at all three levels, Mom, Dad, or the entire family, each having different benefits. In that context, the children often have the most fun and learn without being lectured to about the value of being away from the electronic devices.
- 2.16** You can see one of the propensities of fathers is to turn everything into a game, even going to sleep. And if you can figure out some way of making it fun, and so the child is, then—it seems like there's just a little boy in every man. Is that an illusion or is that a reality? That's a reality, right? But the value of that little boy in every man is the propensity to turn everything into a game, everything into fun. And you see that even in something as simple as going to sleep. I remember with my daughters, it was, if I was in a supermarket and they didn't want to go shopping with me or with anybody, just intuitively, without even knowing consciously what I was doing, I would set up the basket as a basket—as in a basketball—and take the toilet paper and have them compete with each other to see who could get the toilet paper into the basket.
- 2.17** That was just if it came to them taking math lessons, I'd go over to the cereal box and say, "Okay, what cereal—among all these cereals on the shelf—what cereal has the least amount of sugar and the least amount of added sugar?" And so they would then guess and then look and then see who could get the closest to the cereal that had the least amount of added sugar. And then, of course, at first they might guess, "I'm right because this one has zero, less sugar than that one." Then I'll say, something like, "No, the instruction was added sugar rather than sugar, and so it would be that type of

lesson. But if I created it as a competition, then it was really good until one girl started to become much better at this than the other, and the other one gave up. And so we guys tend to try to figure out some way of making everything A: into a game, and B: everything into a competition. And it does stimulate and like all virtues taken to an extreme, it can go too far.

- 2.18** Here's another example of Dad-style parenting or Dad-style nurturing. So you can imagine that some moms might have a problem with this. And the mom might be holding on like we talked about before with the rough-housing, but then the first time the child really gets hurt—which the child is likely to do eventually—the mom would sort of freak out, and particularly if the mom and dad are divorced and the dad is doing this, and the report comes home from the hospital that that child just broke a leg or an arm. And then that's taken to court and used an argument to keep the father from the child because the father's completely irresponsible, cares more about surfing than they do about the child, cares more about the games than it does about the child. That all sounds very logical and apparent in court, and does not conflict with the way the child feels at the time that it does break an arm or break a leg. And so all of that is part of the dynamic of parenting, especially when divorced today.
- 2.19** One of the most important and least understood things about dads and Mom-parenting styles is the impact of teasing. And teasing comes in multiple different forms. I'll give you one that is common and then share one that is less common. Here's— "Hey, undercover. Agent Sanders. I've been telling you for a while, sir, please, no NO! Pull up the car. Pull it over now. Look at the car. I'm not going to ask you again. Ahhhhh" [laughter] " Yeah, we got Him. He's rolling down intersection G. He's not down. Pull over! Woah!" [laughter] "Pull over! Ahhhhhh! Yeah!" So that's one type of teasing, and that usually goes very well. And then sometimes the dad will take that just a step beyond what the child feels comfortable with. And what happens? The child starts crying. And sometimes the level of excitement will predict the level of the cry because all that gets let out in a different emotional type of format.
- 2.20** There's a second type of teasing that is very rarely talked about, which is the teasing that masks a criticism. So dads are much more likely to use teasing as sort of a fruit smoothie that covers up wheatgrass. So the wheatgrass is the equivalent of the criticism. And the fruit smoothie is the teasing. So the teasing is a lot of fun, but oftentimes embedded in the tease is like, "Oh, you took those cherries from your sister, that there were ten cherries and they were supposed to be five for you and five for your sister, and you took eight out of the ten. Oh, you're really a generous guy, aren't you? Big cherry man? Really, you're filled with all the right decisions, and you're really generous, Mr. Generous." And so then the dad will make something out of it, "Mr. Generous, how are you?" And the dad will become really silly, but underneath it all, he's giving that wheatgrass, getting the criticism across, but acting silly, and sort of

getting the child to not feel as much of the negative impact of the criticism as the child might otherwise feel.

2.21 But oftentimes the child will end up crying nevertheless. And then mom feels like, "That was so insensitive. Didn't you see that that was going to lead to the child crying?" And sometimes it does and sometimes it doesn't. But from the mom's perspective, it only has to lead to the crying maybe one out of five times to be seen as insensitive because that's the time that is remembered. And of course, if the child goes back home in a divorce situation and reports to the mom that the dad made him cry or her cry one or two or three times, that makes the mom feel like maybe she's not making the right decision by allowing the dad to have an equal amount of time with the children, and the mom is doing it from a natural instinct to protect, and the dad is doing it from his way of being a dad. And the solution is not Mom-style parenting or Dad-style parenting, it's understanding the value of each parent's parenting, because teasing taken too far becomes bullying.

2.22 Most important, if the dad does not have a bond, if the only thing the dad is doing is criticizing through teasing and spending very little other time with the child, then teasing has a very different impact than if the dad and the child have been having a lot of bond together—there's been a lot of involvement. And one of the reasons it's so important for—if there is a divorce—to have an equal amount of time, both father and mother, with the children, is because that does allow the father time to bond with the child in fun ways, in nature ways, and in game ways. That allows the child to see the father as something more than a constant criticizer may be covered up with teasing. So teasing has to be in context. The context must include a lot of love, a lot of time, a lot of bonding, and then the child can handle criticism and particularly see criticism as part of a fun thing that the child and the dad sort of share together in a different type of way.

2.23 Now, I've talked about this and worked with moms about this. And so moms say, "Oh, that's a really good point." And so oftentimes, a mom will go ahead upon, after talking to me before I knew better to do the teasing with the child. And the mom reports back to me what happens. The child ends up crying, almost invariably, because the child didn't understand that Mom-language does not include teasing. So it understood Mom to speak this language and Dad to speak that language. So it interpreted Dad's language differently than Mom's language.

2.24 And so when it came to Mom doing the teasing, she had to really explain to the child, "I'm going to tease a little bit more like Dad teases. Okay, do you want me to do that?" And get the child aligned with, "I'm going to teach you a new language. It's going to be the same language you do with Dad, but now teasing coming from me is going to be a lot of fun as opposed to just, you're going to hear the criticism only." And so dads and moms oftentimes have different enough languages and styles that we really have to—if we're going to adjust the child to the dad having the mom style or the mom style

having the dad style—then it's really very helpful to educate the child as to the fact that they're learning a different language.

- 2.25** Another thing that dads and children and grandchildren tend to do is— this is grandpa and grandson. Grandpa looks an awful lot like me. I have no idea why—and this is building the sandcastle that lasts. Obviously, the sandcastle that we were building together didn't last very long, but the sandcastle that we were building psychologically lasts a lifetime, hopefully.
- 2.26** Okay, we've looked at what the children miss when they miss their dad. Now I'm going to turn a lot more serious and look at the whole concept of Dad-deprived boys are boys, often, who hurt. And again, they're not always boys who hurt, but very often the boys who hurt are often Dad-deprived. And here are some of the evolution of what happens with the hurt. Dad-deprived boys, how they hurt—they're far more likely to commit crimes like we saw in the Moynihan Report of inner-city violence.
- 2.27** They're far more likely to do drug dealings. I shared before about how a Dad-deprived boy often feels without family, alone, unmotivated, that leads him to feeling like he's a loser because he doesn't have a car like some other kid has a car. And so he goes out and realizes that he can make ten times as much money selling drugs as he can flipping hamburgers. And so he's tempted into the drug dealing as a method of earning money, but also as a community, as a family, as a substitute family, something he's part of. Dad-deprived boys are far more likely to bully interestingly, Dad-deprived boys are far more likely to be bullied. The background and the psychology of the bully and the bullied are actually quite similar.
- 2.28** And then Dad-deprived boys are far more likely to be among the mass shooters. Among those mass shooters, Dad-deprivation is a huge issue that I'll get into in a minute. Anthony Sims, his last post was, "I wish I had a father." And the next day he was the Oakland killer, 19-year-old charged in slaying of West Oakland mother. Salvador Ramos—raise your hand if you remember who Salvador Ramos was, the Uvalde shooter, the school shooter. Our headlines tend to shout, "The reason for mass shootings are poor family values. They're bad mental health, their violence in the media, their violence in video games." Yet boys and girls come from the same homes with the same family values, exposed to the same amount of violence in the same media, exposed to the same video games. We hear that the reason may be guns and guns, video game violence, all those things may be part of the causes. They all have their impact. But boys, girls don't do the shootings.
- 2.29** Despite having the same number of guns and access to the same guns in the same homes, and being just as capable of pulling a trigger as a male, being just as likely to be influenced by violence, maybe not as likely to watch it. And yet the mass shootings are largely not done by girls. They're done about 99% by boys or young men or older men. There were nine school shootings that involved ten or more people being killed during the 21st century. Those nine school shootings, we have the family backgrounds of eight

of them. Of the eight of them that we have the family backgrounds for, seven out of those eight boys were Dad-deprived boys. Seven out of the eight boys that did school shootings of ten or more people in the 21st century— Dad-deprived boys. Often with vicious arguments with their mother, that was very typical that we saw happened, in the case of the boy that wrote me, Carlos. School shootings are mostly white boys, method of acting out their hopelessness. More recently, older males and a greater diversity of males have been included in shootings. This is not the way we want diversity, equity, and inclusion to evolve. Boys who hurt us are boys who hurt.

2.30 We look now at Cause #2, which is a half century of belief of girls and women are powerless, males have toxicity, males have privilege, males have power, we all emanate from a patriarchy in which men made the rules to benefit men at the expense of women. And that leading to a feeling that if we do identify boys as having a problem, that those boys will eventually become men who have all these advantages anyway. And so why focus on boys problems? And even worse, if you do focus on boys problems, maybe that shows an insensitivity to girls and women's problems, which really identifies you as a misogynist, as all of which we mentioned before. And so let's explore where that leads to, and some of the things that that's led to.

2.31 One is, boys benefit a great deal from recess, and for reasons that I'll deal with in the solutions section. But in this benefit from recess, not seeing that boys learn differently than girls, which a fellow named Michael Gurian really writes some very good books about, and how boys learn and how girls learn, and that boys learn a lot more by doing. We need physical activity at first and so on, that these things are crucial to boys development, they also happen to be crucial for girls' development. When I get into the data on recess, you'll see that it affects both girls and boys positively, in ways that are almost counterintuitive—but more on that in the solutions section. But when we did reduce recess, it seemed to be very sound decision making, because we didn't have the way boys learn in mind, because recess competed with "Well, they should have more time learning algebra. They should have more time learning calculus." So it seemed like we were doing something positive for the school curriculum because we had a complete lack of consciousness as to the value of recess, because we didn't see how crucial, we weren't observant of how crucial it was to boys.

2.32 Vocational education is a huge thing that began to be reduced years ago, and still in some schools, it's beginning to come back. But in many schools, it is very much less than it could be and should be. And so there's this enormous gap between the employer demand for employees and the employee supply of skilled workers. And that's leading to a lot of problems for boys. And they're reflected in this Wall Street Journal article of April 10, of 2023, which is construction industry has work, but needs more workers. And so, so many things that are needed in technology, in the areas of labor that males tend to be more prone toward, are missing the training through vocational education to make those workers effective. And it has a huge impact on

boys. And so the opportunity to learn skill sets that boys oftentimes resist learning, like physics and chemistry.

2.33 If you teach boys physics and chemistry independently, they really usually don't like it, or often don't like it, or at least a certain percentage of boys, particularly boys that are not academically inclined, don't like it. But if you tell a boy that the physics and chemistry will allow you to be a much more high paid welder, and you give the boy the incentive of being a welder, and he sees that physics and chemistry are necessary to that higher pay, and therefore him being more respected and therefore being able to make better money to support his family, to attract a woman, to do the things like that, then boys will learn the physics and chemistry that seemed abstract. Boys need to have it tied into a purpose. Girls are better at being able just to say, "Okay, I'm expected to learn physics. I'm expected to learn chemistry. I better learn physics, and I better learn chemistry, even if it's in the harder class type of thing." That's a very different reaction to the learning process that was completely not in our consciousness.

2.34 In this half-century of attitude toward not paying attention to the way boys learn. We've had a lack of male teachers, and that has not been inspiring for boys, especially for boys that of were Dad-deprived in their home, going from a Dad-deprived home to Dad-deprived schools. And when I talk about lack of male teachers, many people think of the type of man that I tend to be, which is sort of a nurturer connector man is my core personality. But we need more than just the type of man that I am in the school as teachers. We need working class men. We need not just nurture, connector type of men. We need provider, protector men. We need men who have different values, different educations, different backgrounds, so that a boy who is Dad-deprived will have a role model he can identify with. And I'm a role model that some people can identify with, but we need multiple role models for boys to be able to identify with somebody that comes more naturally to them.

2.35 There's something very powerful that is happening that fortunately, we've had only recent data to put our fingers on, which is the unconscious bias against boys. When a teacher doesn't know it's a boy, the boy is 1/3 more likely to be graded higher on a reading test. When a teacher doesn't know it's a boy, the boy is 1/3 more likely to be graded higher on a reading test. The obvious result is low self-esteem. Boys begin to believe that they can't do it better. I remember in 9th grade— and there's also a dual responsibility here—I remember when I was in 9th grade, I lived in Europe and one of the boys in the class was a real goofball, very smart, but used it to make jokes and to get attention in those types of ways. Something got into him and he told me and somebody else that he was going to really do study for the next test. And he really did study for the next test and he thought he really wrote a really good essay. And then he got graded a C and he was confused.

2.36 And he went up to Katie, who was the real name of this female student and she was the best student in the class. And he read her essay and read, his essay and he said,

"Katie, I think my essay is as good as yours. Do you think so?" And Katie, being a really honest woman, girl, said, "Yeah, actually this is a great essay, George, I never expected this from you, but it's a really good essay." And so both Katie and George went up to Mrs. Dietermeyer, our teacher in the 9th grade, and said, "Could you take a look at both of these essays and do a fair judgment as to whether about them?" And Mrs. Dietermeyer said, "Okay, I will."

- 2.37** She looked over both essays and said, "George, I am sorry. This is a really good essay. But the truth is I had so much background about you not writing good essays. I just quickly gave it a glance and gave you the C that I normally give you without really evaluating it carefully." And then she acknowledged that to the whole class, but she also added something else. She said, "George, I want you to know this is the power of reputation. When you build a reputation, you get an outcome of people judging you before they have the full story. So I want to take responsibility for the mistake I made, but I also want you to take responsibility for building a good reputation wherever you go in life." I thought that was a really good answer that she gave and a good combination of responsibility and expecting somebody who is judged by stereotype to also not just expect the stereotype to change without changing the behavior that created the stereotype. And obviously, the outcome of this type of difference is low self-esteem.
- 2.38** Another area where that's happened in the last half-century that is very powerful is what's happening in our attitude toward hiring and firing. Human resources are oftentimes called "HR", but they're often a place where girls and women are not usually girls, but women go to register their complaints. They really should not be called "HR" because that suggests human, which suggests both sexes should be going there about equally to register their complaints, or at least that the complaints might be heard on the part of both sides. Sometimes "HR" has morphed into being more accurately called "HER" or her resources rather than human resources.
- 2.39** And here is the challenge with that. The commerce of masculinity is the trading of wit-covered put-downs. So if I'm a firefighter and David, you're joining the force, and let's say you're the son of the fire chief. If I want to eventually get to the point where I'm respecting David, I'll start teasing him, say, "Well, how's the big son of the fire chief who graduated from Harvard today?" And if you get defensive, I start to worry. But if you can play along with it and say, "The son of the fire chief is just fine," or something along those lines, and he's played along with it, and he's taken it a step further.
- 2.40** So he's now beginning to not be a prima donna about being criticized. He's beginning to be somebody I can begin to trust. And if I'm in a room where the roof is falling in the middle of a fire, am I going to trust somebody who's a prima donna? Or am I going to trust somebody who'd be willing to risk his life to save mine? And so testing men out to see if they have not a prima donna outlook on life, but they're willing to sacrifice, is a way I test people to see who I can trust and therefore who I can admit into the circle of

trust. But if I take that same attitude toward a new woman at work and I start teasing her about, "Well, maybe you're masculine enough. You're sure fat enough. Maybe you're this or that or whatever it is," and not see that that teasing is a way of seeing if she can handle that type of teasing. And if she can, I'm beginning to feel that no matter what I put out toward her, she could handle, and she'll get back at me, but not in a cruel type of way, but in a way that sort of dances with me and my teasing. Now I can begin to trust her.

2.41 But if a woman doesn't know that and she's new from her perspective, that, very validly, is interpreted as, "I'm being discriminated against, because I'm a woman," especially if she's in a predominantly male atmosphere, where that type of behavior and teasing is likely to be predominant, and where we don't train through HR, we don't train boys and men and women and girls to have a dialog about what that meaning of teasing is. And in fact, that that teasing was men's unconscious way of potentially admitting her into the group, into the club, and being female, positive. But to the female, it sure doesn't appear that way. And so the female does what she goes to HR and she reports that to HR. And from an HR perspective, usually a female there, that feels pretty much like an awful thing to do. Now, who did that? You need to tell me, because we need to make sure that he's not promoted or disciplined. And so he then ends up seeing that whoever did that was up for promotion, but no longer is up for promotion or is out-and-out fired.

2.42 And so that triggers the men into saying, there's two groups of people here. The men I can tease and play with and trust and decide who enters into my trust circle, and women who I have to walk on eggshells around, which is actually, in my opinion, discrimination against women. But the woman doesn't understand it, the man doesn't understand it, and HR is not facilitating that dialog. There needs to be, in HR, sessions where everybody is talking about these things openly and honestly. And if a man gives his perspective on that, he's not put down, as he often is in HR sessions, as mansplaining. Because once a man is put down for mansplaining, then he then sees that by speaking up at these sessions and giving the male perspective, he's more likely to be seen as somebody who's not female- friendly and therefore not promotable, and so he shuts up.

2.43 So the dialog needs to be constructed by people who know how to facilitate dialog, who know how to sort of draw out from people what they're really feeling and create a safe environment. Which means sophisticated versions of getting all male groups, all female groups, have the outcome of male groups and female groups be communicated safely with each other, rewarding men and women who speak up and speak their truth, rather than punishing men and women who speak up and speak their truth. All of these things are not part of most HR sessions because we were so ingrained with the attitude that women and girls need this protection. And therefore, if they are victims, they should report their victimhood immediately and speak up about it. And they're even

encouraged to do that reporting of the victimhood and what happens with women who report themselves as victim? They often get victim power. That is, they often get promoted to sort of compensate for the discrimination that's been against them.

- 2.44 And what does this do to males opinions of women? It makes males fearful of women but not respect women more. And this is a crime because everyone needs to be respected, and everyone needs to know that whatever they're feeling and they're saying there should be a safe space for sharing that, until we are able to hear each other's perspectives. We may not agree, but we need to hear those perspectives. And so I plead with HR and plead with all of us to begin to reach out and share that every HR department and every corporation and every university be required to learn how to facilitate the perspectives of both sexes and people who fall everywhere in between, trans, straight, gay, etc. Hiring and firing—often we hear diversity, equity, and inclusion. And given what I just shared with you, for men, this often feels like not diversity, equity, and inclusion, but exclusion and exclusion from having a voice in HR, which has become HER.
- 2.45 So these things happen in the corporate community and the university community and are happening every day in those communities and the political community as well. And so in addition to this, we see a number of other things happening like this, we hear "the future is female". Imagine how "the future is female" inspires your adolescent son for his future. Already motivation low, but also all around you hearing about these types of issues. We have bestsellers, like a bestselling book you may remember by Hannah Rosin called The End of Men. That doesn't exactly inspire boys for thinking that they have a really good future.
- 2.46 We hear appellations such as "toxic masculinity". And again, this does not build boys' self-esteem. On a much more mild level, of course, we hear things like, "boys are stupid, throw rocks at them." How many of you have seen this or something like this in the culture? Just raise your hand if you have. This is not just a book. This is a book, this is posters, this is t-shirts, this is coffee cups. The only thing I haven't seen sold in relation to "boys are stupid, throw rocks at them" is they haven't been selling yet rocks themselves. But there are dozens of examples of this type of message out there, and obviously it does not inspire our sons for their future.
- 2.47 Another big one is boys as the patriarchal oppressors, and this is "burn the patriarchy". In junior high school, boys are hearing things like, the patriarchy is designed to benefit men at the expense of women. And I've been told by more than one boy this has made me wish that I never was born a boy. I feel like I'm being condemned just because I exist. I was doing an interview, filming of an interview on this issue in Mill Valley, where I live outside of San Francisco. And during the filming, there was a pathway in which. And I was talking about boys'experiences in high school. And I saw a young man that looked like he might be about high school age walking just by the river where I was perched at a rock, a large rock. And I said to the film people, "I want to ask that guy

down here to see if he really identifies with this, to make sure that I'm not just talking theory."

2.48 So I asked the guy, and we explained to him what we were doing and that he was going to be on film, but that we would run the film by him before to make sure he could edit out anything he wanted. And he said, okay. And so I asked him, "What are the messages that you hear in school about males versus females?" And he came up with a lot of these types of messages, especially the "patriarchy" one and especially the "toxic masculinity" one and the "male privilege" one. Those were the three that he particularly focused on. So then I asked him a deeper question. I said, "Are you heterosexual?" And he says, "Yes." I said, "Do you have a girlfriend?" He said, "Yes." And I said, "Do you really care a lot about her?" He said, "Yes." I said, "Do you talk to her about these issues?" And he said, "Oh, no." Like, I was almost crazy for asking the question. And I said, "Well, why not?" And he said, "She'd think I was some type of woman hater." And so I said, "Well, if you really—how long have you been together?" And he said, "Something like 4 or 5 months. I said, "If you were together a few years and you were thinking about asking her to marry you, would you talk with her then about these issues?" Long pause.

2.49 Seeing that I was on the side, feeling that I was on the side of having a conversation, he sort of budged a little bit and said, "Well, maybe." So we talked about how deeply sad it is that here is somebody that will be his, potentially, ideally, his soulmate. And he wasn't feeling comfortable speaking about these issues, lest he be called a woman hater, lest he be called a misogynist. And again, I just picked this boy out. He's in 9th grade, and he's already hearing all of these messages that I'm talking about. And this is in supposedly an enlightened community in Northern California, of course.

2.50 This one is a really tough one. We hear basically "a woman's child, a woman's choice". And so I'm going to go deep here. Dad involvement is considered a mother's choice, rather than vital to children. And the rights of the fathers are rarely considered, except as if you start pressing for the rights of fathers, you're considered something's wrong with you. So let me reframe the debate about abortion, as a possible debate where something is missing. I would like to call this a consideration of men's ABC rights. So I'm asking the question, "What's missing from the abortion debate?" And the answer, I believe, is that dad's missing.

2.51 That the dichotomy of "right to life", on the one hand, versus "a woman's body, a woman's choice", on the other hand, is missing a possible win-win solution in some cases, a dad's right to care for the future infant. The potential of at least considering the possibility that we have an option of not killing something that we can love. And so the creation of a fetus, instead of being "a woman's body, a woman's choice", or the "right to life" has a possibility of three choices to be considered as three rights in tension. Right #1 is the right of the fetus to live. Right #2 is the right of the mother to have a choice, and Right #3 is the right of the dad to have a choice.

- 2.52** Let me be more specific about the right of the dad to have a choice. What's been missing, I think, from the debate, and again, I'm not creating an answer. I'm creating something that I think should be part of the discussion is what might be called men's or dad's ABC rights and responsibilities. Right A is abortion. Should the dad have the right to be informed immediately that the mother is considering abortion so he may legally affirm he will care for the infant both emotionally and financially from birth till at least age 18. Again, I'm not saying that this is the right answer, but rather this isn't even part of the debate.
- 2.53** Number two, the B right—birth. Should the dad have the right to have a birth control pill, injections, or the now in development nonhormonal form of a male birth control pill? Male birth control should not just be a woman's burden, nor should it be a woman's issue. It frees women from only her body being subjected to hormone manipulation. And so oftentimes we focus on this as a male issue. No, it's a male issue and a female issue. It's a right for both. And can he share then share the responsibility to prevent through having a male birth control hormone or pill? Can he share that right and share that obligation to have an unwanted pregnancy to begin with?
- 2.54** Number C possible right to consider is the right of caring. A pregnant mom often chooses to care for the child exclusively or put the child up for abortion, thus depriving the child of its biological father. And should the biological father have the right to be informed when a mother is thinking that way before the mother makes the final decision? So the male knows and all three parents.
- 2.55** We want fathers to be more involved, but people tend not to get more involved in something that they don't have responsibility for from the beginning. The more we involve people in the choice, everybody knows, the more people feel a responsibility, the more inspired they are, the more they feel that they're needed, that they're wanted, that they're part of the process. So, in brief, the potential parents chose to have sex. To prevent the fetus from being aborted, should the mother taking responsibility for nine months and the dad taking responsibility for 18 years become something that we at least discuss? Should we have a debate about whether a fetus being protected and raised with love rather than aborted and with an often traumatized mom and an ignored dad is at least a viable option to be discussed?
- 2.56** We have to challenge the era of moms having the right to children and dads having to fight for children. I do a lot of expert witness work, unfortunately, because I should have to do none on helping judges understand the right to, the importance of children to have both mother and father in their life and have four different parameters. The research that I've done has led me to understanding that after divorce, there are four things that are absolutely essential for both boy and girl children to have. I'll discuss those in the solution section. This information is frequently not understood by judges, not understood by fathers, and not understood by mothers, and that's really a type of crime.

- 2.57 Here. Obviously, you see Brad Pitt. He had to fight for the children, even with all the power that he has with Angelina Jolie, of course. The problem is that dads with money often don't have the time, and dads with the time often don't have the money. The average person who calls me to be an expert witness has already spent \$100,000. The average person who calls me to be an expert witness, which means I'm involved in the next stage of the argument or the debate in court. That means he's already spent \$100,000. He spends money on me, spends money on his attorney even beyond that, \$100,000. The only people who can afford that are fairly wealthy men.
- 2.58 But the problem with the very wealthy men is oftentimes it takes a lot of time to create wealth, and you don't have as much time with your children as you'd like to have. And so we create this dilemma between men having to earn all of this money to spend more time with children, knowing intuitively that the children benefit more from Dad's time than Dad's dime. But on the other hand, the ones that know this and don't make a lot of money can't afford an expert witness, can't afford a lawyer, can't afford to fight it in court. And so this is a lose-lose situation in the long run. Dad-involvement is often misinterpreted as an insult to a mom rather than as a support to single moms.
- 2.59 I went around and interviewed a lot of presidential candidates, which I do before each election. And I interviewed John Hickenlooper and Andrew Yang. Andrew Yang really understood the importance of Dad-involvement, and John Hickenlooper was willing to be educated by me. And so they both started to take on the issue. And both of their campaign managers separately saw their beginning of an attachment to this issue. And independently, they came up to me and said, "You know, Dr. Farrell, this is kind of dangerous, what we're doing. We want John and Andrew to win the primaries, but for that purpose, we need the feminist base.
- 2.60 And the feminist base is going to be alienated if we're saying that dads should have an equal amount of involvement in the raising of children. And then as for single mothers, that's going to feel like an insult to single mothers feeling that we're saying that dads are necessary when they've been working their ass off to raise their children." And I felt so deeply sad and deeply defeated because these were the two men that really got this issue. And their campaign managers were saying, "No way can they bring this up." And fortunately, Andrew Yang has brought this up, but he had to start his own party, the forward party. And so it's really an example of what has to be done in this type of context.
- 2.61 So to end this part, we've generated in this era what I would call the multi option woman, and we'll see what I call the man. Women's three options are option one, to work full time. This is if they live in a middle class or upper class home and they're having children. Option two is to be full time with the children and they're married. And option three is to do some combination of both. Statistically speaking, women who have children, 40% work full time, but they cut back on the full time hours, 40% work are full time with the children and 20% do some combination of both. Men's three

option— we have three options, too. Option 1 is to work full time. Option 2 is to work full time, and option 3 is to work full time. Or if they're a working class man, work two jobs, or if they're a wealthier or a white collar worker, work overtime. More on that tomorrow. It's great talking with you today. Thanks.

Lecture 3: Purpose Void

At a glance — The 'purpose void' — Farrell's third cause of the boy crisis — and how a lost sense of purpose shapes boys' development.

- 3.1** So today, I'm going to start out with talking about the "Purpose Void", which is the number three purpose, the #3 Cause of the Boy Crisis, as I see it, or I'll be explaining it. And overall, the "Purpose Void" is that, traditionally speaking, men had two basic purposes. They could serve in war, and they could provide—pretty much obvious to all of us. But what is less obvious is that there was a common denominator to those two purposes. One is the serving in war led to men promising that they would risk being disposable and serving at work, 93% of the workplace deaths are to men. And so if they're not disposable in working class jobs like construction, lumberjacks, and so on, that lead to men being disposable at work. They're often disposable by climbing the ladder to success, which we'll talk about later.
- 3.2** As they get more and more up the ladder of success, a lot of things happen. They lose time with their family. They oftentimes become more of a human doing than a human being. And so I'll be talking more about that in a little while. But that's sort of an overall sense of what men's purpose has been all around the world, in virtually every country, whether they're poor or whether they're developed, that was some version of men's purpose globally. And so in the last bit of time, there's been some changes in that. And that's what the first thing that I'll be looking at.
- 3.3** The first change is that fewer men needed to be disposable in war and at work. And the reason for that is that women were sharing much more, are sharing today much more the breadwinning responsibilities. Good news or bad news? From my perspective, good news. Good news, because it means there doesn't need to be as much pressure on men to have to do jobs that they don't want to do in order to make more money. And I'll talk more about that dynamic of doing what you don't want to do in order to make more money— the paradox of male power.
- 3.4** So men are freer to do more fulfilling work that usually pays what more or less? Usually pays less, because the more fulfilling the work is, the more people want to do it in relation to the supply of people that are needed to do it. So, for example, in college as an art history major, and you know all about art history, there are chances that people need you less to interpret the paintings on your wall than they need you to pick up the garbage. So the person with a master's degree in art history has a very fulfilling possible job, but maybe only 1 in 100 get the job. Whereas with the garbage collector, even if you're not trained to be a garbage collector, if it's such a need for you, you can get hired as that garbage collector.
- 3.5** Second piece of good news is that we saw before how men are oftentimes not getting as many bachelor's degrees, master's degrees, and doctorates as they used to. And so

that's sad on one hand. On the other hand, there's a whole new piece of good news occurring, which is that the health professions are in great need of many people. Many people in the health professions are people who do not need to have MDs like they used to. There's a huge amount of availability for people in the caring professions, in such areas as physicians assistants, nurse practitioners, traveling nurses can make \$120,000-\$150,000 as traveling nurses. So if you're a single and you're a man and you're open to doing caring profession work, there's a significant amount of potential income out there for you. There's MFTs are needed. MFTs and MSWs are predominantly females. There's an enormous need. MSWs go into poor homes.

3.6 When a female, who is usually trained as an MSW, to think of men as having all the power and often being the people that are the domestic violence people. When a female trained that way goes into a poor home, she does not help that poor home integrate males and females into that home. There is an enormous need for males in the MSW earning professions and to be social workers. There's an enormous need for men to be marriage and family therapists. The great majority of marriage and family therapists are women. That's great for about half of women to be marriage and family therapists and half of women to be MSWs. But when it becomes 90% women and 10% men, that becomes an out-of-balance profession and 2 professions that need a great deal of balance. Today among boys and men in their 20s—when I was younger, psychiatrists were almost all male. Today, only 10% of psychologists who are in their 20s are male. And so again, obviously, there's a need for balance.

3.7 So the bad news is that those professions are way out of balance. The good news is that for men who are open to breaking from the stereotype of being a soldier, being a construction worker, if you're willing to break from tradition and get involved in a caring profession, the caring professions will be growing enormously. And there's an enormous need for men. And the connection in the caring professions is very high purpose. When you are a man contributing to a poor family, doing, understanding how to integrate a male as a father into the poor community, which are the communities that usually have a smaller percentage of males, you are really accomplishing something, and you will feel and see that accomplishment.

3.8 So that's the opportunity that's out there in that next generation. But it requires flexibility in terms of not thinking about the only way to be a man is to do traditional male work. There's probably one characteristic that defines all of human achievement, and that's the ability to adapt. This is a time that will require enormous adaptation. Women have already had a 50 year head start on adapting, and we've been telling women when they're girls, you go girl. But we haven't been saying the same thing to boys. And the result of that is many, many boys have thought that they have to do the old professions and not open their mind up to the fields that are really growing in the future and the fields that will offer purpose. And very few boys without purpose do nearly as well as boys who feel they have purpose.

- 3.9** Okay, but there's some bad news. For many boys and young men who are not very adaptable, disposability as purpose has been replaced by no purpose. And this picture is all too familiar to many homes and many families. And this is especially true if the males remain rigid in expectation of being the old type of males and the old type having the old type of purposes. Bad news number two is Dad-deprived boys are often purpose-deprived boys. So the exploration here is, why is it that Dad-deprived boys are purpose-deprived boys? What is that connection? Here's the five steps that are so important to understanding the connection between Dad-deprivation and the creation of purpose.
- 3.10** Number one is that discovering a child's purpose now requires identifying their unique self. Remember when I shared about my dad and how when I showed some promise as a writer, my father was really afraid of me becoming my unique self because I was doing my doctorate and I was already assistant also to the president of NYU. And he was so proud of me that I was climbing up a traditional ladder doing my doctorate, "And already you're assistant to the president of NYU. You will definitely be a president of a major university. This is great."
- 3.11** But from my perspective, I got to be in that role, and I saw the president was spending most of his time raising money for a private university, and this is not what I wanted to be doing all my life, is raising money for something. Raising money and asking for money was not my thing. But when I started to show some promise as a writer, he started to say, as I mentioned yesterday, "Be careful, Warren, only 1 in 100 writers get publishers. You can't find a publisher. You can't find a wife." So he felt it was his contribution to my life to make sure I gave up being my unique self and did what a responsible man does, which is to climb that ladder at the top to earn more money, have more prestige, and have more, quote, "power".
- 3.12** But from my perspective, that was the opposite of power, because it wasn't giving me control over my own life. But today, for the first time in history, especially in countries like the United States, where survival in the middle and upper and middle class is not as a controlling factor, we have the possibility of defining somebody's working to discover our child's unique self, as Marc Gafni puts it. And that unique self is a job that both father and mother can be involved in. Mother is usually very good, mothers are usually very good at saying, "Sweetie, you are such a good singer. You could be a wonderful singer." "You really did those gymnastics terrifically. You could be fantastic at that." And really encouraging and seeing the talent, even, it may be above and beyond what that talent might be in the real world.
- 3.13** And then a dynamic starts to happen with Mom and Dad. The child starts to begin to experiment with that talent. And there's sort of 5 steps that tend to happen. Step #1 is that the mother and father go through a dynamic as to helping that child identify and appreciate how unique his or herself is. And that's done in different ways by Mom and Dad. The dad part, #2, is that manifesting unique self requires postpone gratification.

#3, the postpone gratification requires the boundary enforcement. #4, Dad-deprived children are often boundary enforcement deprived. And then #5, therefore, the child often does not manifest her or his purpose.

- 3.14** So for an example, the child is very good maybe at gymnastics or wants to be in the Olympics, because she or he is good at basketball or anything that is skiing or ice skating. And so the child sees the Olympics and says, I really want to be in the Olympics. And both sexes, both Mom and Dad, are very "Okay. If you want to be in the Olympics, great." But usually it's more likely to be the dad that will say some version of "You know, Sweetie, if you are going to be in the Olympics, it's going to require you giving up, going to parties, giving up video games, giving up a lot of friends. You have to make a lot of sacrifices to be the top in the country or the top in the world at anything you do." "Okay, Dad. But I really want to be in the Olympics." "So if you really want to be in the Olympics, we're willing to. I'll work harder," says the dad or the mom, "And we'll make more money to hire you a tutor and to get you the best instructions, and we'll take you around to different places to be in tournaments and so on. We'll do that. But again, it really requires you giving up a lot of things, too, and that's not necessarily healthy. It's really healthier to have a balanced life. But if your unique self and pride in yourself is into giving up all these things to be at the top of the game of anybody in the world, then we'll support you to do that."
- 3.15** And then the child begins to go on that journey and the parents go out of their way to make this happen. And an invitation to go to a good friend's birthday party comes along and the child doesn't want to give it up. And the child starts crying and mom says what? " "Oh, sweetie, I don't want you to give up the birthday party. That's okay. Yes, you should have a balanced life." And is the mom right? Of course the mom's right, the child should have a balanced life. But the mom is also in tension with the dream.
- 3.16** And so the dad is more likely to say some version of, "You know, Sweetie, it's perfectly fine to have a balanced life. I think it's healthier to have a balanced life. But if you're going to make a decision to be an Olympic champion or at the top of the game, you're not going to have a balanced life. Mom and I can't be struggling morning, noon, and night to provide income and tutoring and travel and everything else for you if you're going to not get where you want to get. So it's fine to do whatever you'd like to do, but we can't have one and not the other." And so the child is more likely to have, with dad involved, a choice to either have a balanced and healthy life or do an unbalanced and unhealthy life, but you're the top of the game and you get a different type of pride and you'll probably die sooner.
- 3.17** There's a saying called "the good die young". And if you look at people who are good performers, they oftentimes become extremely stressed and then start taking drugs. And often don't know who really loves them for who they are versus who loves them because of their achievements. And that leads to more depression, and even as

everybody else thinks they're being applauded, and so that becomes another side of that whole spectrum.

- 3.18** Bad news #3—there's a lack of transition from Dad's old role to Dad's new role. The old role created what I call a father's catch-22. And the old traditional role for men creates a conflict between success and love. And neither of these things are talked about, almost at all, in the culture. So let me elaborate on both of those. First, the father's catch-22—dads learned to love their family by being away from their love of their family. This is deeply sad, but also deeply true.
- 3.19** For example, a local sales rep is doing fairly well locally, but he has a child, and the mom says, "I want to at least be involved more with the child." And the mom either cuts back, still works full time, but cuts back the hours, or decides to work full time with the children, or decides to do some combination of both, maybe working 20 hours a week and being with the children the greater amount of time. So Mom exercises one of those 3 options, and Dad says, "Well, if that's the case, in order to be able to provide all the income that we need for the child and the possible college and emergencies and so on, in order to do all that, I've got to not take a job as a local sales rep, but I've got to accept that possible position coming up to be a national sales rep or a regional sales rep. But being that regional sales rep means flying from Miami to California or to Ohio or to some exciting place like North Dakota—I didn't mean that North Dakotans.
- 3.20** And so there's a tendency for the father to perceive that that earning of money is going to be something that the family needs, but he has to be away from the very family for whom he's earning money. And so he learns to love the family by being away from the love of the family.
- 3.21** With CEOs, something else happens, and with Uber drivers, something else happens, and cab drivers. So CEOs and Uber drivers and cab drivers, they have one thing in common. They both work about 70 hours a week. If you don't believe that, go into, especially any cab driver or Uber driver, and their usual combined hours at their Uber work or with their other job, or the Uber job alone amounts to about 70 hours a week. And so if they're doing the 70 hours a week version, usually they have children and feel that that's a need for that. The last three Uber drivers I had I checked that out within all three, that was the case. And so he learns to do that 70-hour work week. The CEO, the average CEO puts in about 70 hours a week, is away from home, a great deal of time and experiences the father's catch-22. But that's not the big problem.
- 3.22** The big problem is what I would call the success/love conflict. Let's say you're a CEO and you're up at the top of the ladder. What you learn to do as a CEO is to really think a lot while a presentation is being made to you. Say you're the CEO of Microsoft, and there's somebody that's saying that, "Listen, we have new great chips that are coming up that can do these miraculous things. And this is somebody from, let's say, South Korea that is talking to you. And you're starting to say to yourself, "Well, now, wait a minute. Do we have the infrastructure in South Korea to be able to build that? How

does that compete with somebody else that talked with me from Taiwan and that they've already got some infrastructure? And what's the tensions that will be between Taiwan and China? And what will be the tensions between South Korea and North Korea." And you're thinking all this while this presenter is presenting to you. "What's the background of this person, the sales representative who's coming to me? What's their reputation for reliability? What's their past history? How do I do my due diligence? Who should I put in charge of due diligence? If you're a good CEO, you are self-listening while the person who's talking to you is making the sales presentation.

- 3.23** You're listening to yourself create all the discussions and questions that you need to have, and then you have 100 different responsibilities. You have only that 15 minutes or that half hour to meet with that person. You've got to make a quick decision as to, "How do I figure out, do all my due diligence, who do I contact? Who do I contact in South Korea, in Taiwan, in China about the reliability?" and so on. And all of those things are functional to be successful as a CEO.
- 3.24** But you come home and your wife says to you, "I've had a really challenging day today at work. I lost this client, and I think I did it because it was a problem that I had." And immediately you're thinking, "I have a solution for that." And so you come up with that solution. Does your wife appreciate that? Why doesn't your wife appreciate that? Because your wife wants to be listened to and heard and not feeling like the unconscious act of providing a solution while your wife is talking is basically saying, "Don't worry, honey. In about 30 seconds, I can figure out things that you couldn't figure out from your entire life experience." Now, that is definitely not the intent. The intent is that my wife is hurting. She's bleeding. I can't possibly have somebody I love bleed any longer than they have to. If I can have a band-aid that I can put on my wife who's bleeding, that is my responsibility, to do it right away! And to get that band-aid on and to solve that problem so she doesn't have to bleed or hurt anymore. However, from the woman's perspective, what is needed is just to hear her out.
- 3.25** My wife owns a public relations firm. She's often very frustrated at the dynamics that are happening in the firm. And I often spend 45 minutes listening to her in the evening talk about the frustration she's experiencing. As you can probably guess as a person who writes books, I solve problems. I work on solving problems. I love solutions to things. And so I just keep my mouth shut during that 45 minutes period. And then before I suggest a solution, I ask her.
- 3.26** I try to empathize with what she must have been through and how that feels to her and so on. And then she'll say, "Well, do you have any ideas?" And I'm not always doing this, but when I'm at my best, I'll say something like, "I have some thoughts, but what are some of your thoughts?" And then she usually, almost invariably, having had a chance to let it all out, does, in fact, have thoughts. And it makes her feel a lot better about herself when those thoughts come from her, rather than I come up with boom,

boom, boom solutions. And so the qualities it takes to be successful at work are in tension with the qualities it takes to be successful in love.

3.27 Now, what I just shared about a wife is one thing, but double the potency of that when the dad is talking with the children. Because the best thing you can do with children is to let them talk through their feelings, talk through their fears, and then ask them, "What would you do? What are some possibilities? You come up with your own solutions." It's far more empowering to a child to come up with their own solutions than it is to have all-wise Dad figure it out for you in a few seconds. And so what so many men who are CEOs experience is that the very things that made them successful at work are exactly the things that made them unsuccessful in love. And that is deeply disappointing because the way men learn to get love is by being successful at work. When men read a business book, it is actually our relationship book, but it teaches us the opposite of what a good relationship needs.

3.28 The other day, when we finished our first session, Mario—young man who'll be here tomorrow—is in his 20s, came up to me and said, "I really want to be a major entrepreneur. So I'm now focused on giving up all my social life so I can be a major entrepreneur and be really respected." And he says, "Dr. Farrell, do you think that's good?" And I said, "No, I think that's terrible." And he goes, "Explain." And I said, "Because what will happen is you will give up all the social skills that you will need to understand love, to understand women, to understand listening, to understand social dynamics. If you pay attention and get involved with women on the way up to do whatever you'll do, you'll have breakups, and you'll be forced to be introspective. What was the common denominator between the last breakup and this breakup? What responsibility do I have? And you'll sort of know a little bit about that, because the woman will tell you what's wrong with you, and so you'll be able to do some good introspective work."

3.29 "If you focus on being an entrepreneur and you don't socialize with women, the chances are better, Mario, that you will be successful at work, and you will be of great interest to all those women who want your money. Because a different type of woman is attracted to a man whose work is struggling, and may or may not become successful. She is usually not a woman who is as attracted or in need of the success that you already have. She's a woman that's willing to play the game with you, to take you, for better or for worse, when it comes to money, because she loves you."

3.30 "But once you're successful, you're more likely to attract a woman who wants a successful man. 'I went out with a man last night,' the woman says to her woman friend, 'and he makes \$5 million a year, and he's going to be selling his firm to somebody else, probably, and getting acquired, and he could make billions.' And, 'Oh,' women friend, 'My God, where'd you find him? And that's great. Do you know of anybody else like that?' And so it pulls into you a type of woman who is more likely to be enamored of your success."

- 3.31** "But then oftentimes, you have gotten that success with the absence of social skills. And as a result, you're more likely to get into arguments with her that you wouldn't have gotten into if you had been involved and schooled in social skills and multiple experiences with multiple women. And she begins to feel not so badly that she now can get a divorce. She could have the two or three children, she could have a good life because she can get half the money from you with a few million dollars and the two children and child support, she can live a happy life and not feel so bad about divorcing you because after all, you kind of are a jerk."
- 3.32** And so that's what the outcome very frequently is. If you focus all your efforts on becoming that successful entrepreneur and don't put that balanced time into developing social skills and understanding real interaction as a woman, you're also objectifying yourself. I said, "You're making yourself into a success object. And then you'll resent women for treating you like a success object. That's not good for the women and it's not good for you." He said, "Thank you." But he's coming back tomorrow so we can get his perspective.
- 3.33** So I'm going to be talking about solutions tomorrow, but just I'll spend a moment on the solutions to this. One of the things that I believe we should be doing at Harvard and other schools like UCLA's Anderson School, training people for MBAs, is to have as part of the MBA curriculum solutions for this type of problem. We do as corporations become global to a greater degree if they're successful. That means you really need people on duty 24 hours a day, seven days a week. How do you do that? The week has 168 hours in it. So maybe have 4 co-CEOs that together would put in 180 hours a week. That would leave 12 hours a week for interaction and communication, time among the CEOs to coordinate what needs to be done, to vote on what needs to be done, and so on. But allow each them 45- hours weeks rather than 70-hours weeks, allowing them a balance between time at work and time with their family.
- 3.34** And I think CEOs will make better decisions when they are involved in family life as well as in corporate life because they'll understand what all their employees, who increasingly, as you probably all know, the more qualified, the more talented the employee is today, the more she or he is increasingly wanting jobs that don't have predictable benefits except for the benefit of more flexibility of time and hours and being able to be with their families. People who are not as qualified don't ask for that as much as people who are extremely talented and extremely qualified. That's the new benefit that counts the most.
- 3.35** And so one of the things that we can do is to begin to train people, okay. If we do have 4 CEOs or 3 CEOs and they're co-CEOs, what are the problems that are likely to come up? How do you solve them when you're working 168 hours a week in different places around the globe? And what are the unique needs of our company? What are the unique needs of those 3 or 4 people? Those are the types of solutions we should be exploring in MBA programs for the future that would allow both the CEO to have a

balanced life and also allow that CEO to feel that she or he is taking care of the responsibilities that the company needs.

- 3.36** And finally, also allow that CEO to spend a higher percentage of his or her time learning to listen, as opposed to problem-solve. Remember your brain, if you're problem-solving all the time, all your neurons, your synapses, begin to morph your brain into quick problem-solving mode. And then that's the opposite of what is needed in a family, which is listening mode, patience mode, facilitative mode, "What do you think?" mode. And if we don't give our top leaders time to do that by having shared positions, rather than all the responsibility of a global company being on their back, the very people who are the most successful at work will become the least successful at love.
- 3.37** Historically speaking, a good dad oftentimes forfeited his dreams. It's not the dream of that many men to be a coal miner, but also many other professions like that, for his child's dream. But real power is being empowered to do what you love and to love who you love. A dad's pay was often about the power that he forfeited, the real power he forfeited to get the power of his pay.
- 3.38** To explain that more in depth. Basically, when you follow your bliss, it's the money you'll miss. Jordan Peterson discovered who I was from a book I wrote called, *Why Men Earn More and What Women Can Do About It*, which is where I wrote this comment about "When you follow your bliss, it's the money you'll miss". And this is one of the key misses that the culture has about understanding the tension between bliss and producing income. The more fulfilling the job, the greater the supply, as I mentioned before, in relation to the demand. And so that's where that comes from. We see this with artists like Vermeer and Van Gogh, who, as you probably know, sold zero to one paintings in their life. They were starving, and obviously, Van Gogh was depressed and killed himself. So very frequently we hear the term starving artists and so people that followed their bliss and did what they thought was really creative and different often in their lifetime suffered enormously.
- 3.39** And many men learned that, like maybe, Mario, saying to himself that, "I really want to be able to get that money, because I really want to be able to get that honey." And that money often does attract that honey. But the problem is it attracts the wrong type of honey too often.
- 3.40** Basically, the road to high pay is a toll road. Does anyone here remember the series *Mad Men*? Just raise your hand if you do. Yeah, the series *Mad Men*, you remember the image of the mad man jumping off of, out of the building and committing suicide. And you may remember that the opening slide here was a picture of the Boy Crisis. And in the Boy Crisis, I have this picture of a boy falling similar to the way the man was falling, historically speaking. And that's because the road to high pay is a toll road. It's the toll of more hours, the toll of more responsibility, the toll of oftentimes leads to drinking and stress. *Mad Men* was filled with men drinking and depressed without even

knowing that they were depressed, acting strong on the outside. It's filled with a toll of less family, more investment.

- 3.41** As you go up the ladder of investing, you feel, "All right, I've spent 18 years getting to this position. Am I going to disagree with my boss now? I see some corruption. Am I going to report it? Am I going to confront it? Well, it's just a little bit of corruption." And you start making excuses because you've invested so much in getting up that ladder that you begin to compromise yourself internally, even as you're having a front of being powerful on the outside. And that's some of the tolls. When I say the road to high pay is a toll road, to say nothing of the fact that you end up with less family like we've been talking about very frequently.
- 3.42** A recent study was done in the National Center for Biotechnology Information discovered that the last words said by men who committed suicide were, "I feel useless and I feel worthless." And so frequently that useless and worthless was, "I'm no longer earning money. I'm no longer achieving my purpose. I'm retired. What purpose do I have? Does anybody really want me for who I am?" And those were found to be the two most frequently used words of men who committed suicide.
- 3.43** One of the most popular games in Japan is a game called Karoshi. Does anyone know what the word "karoshi" means? It means death at the desk or death from overwork. And the game that Japanese youth play has these Karoshi figures, everybody gets a Karoshi figure, and the person who wins each round gets to advance up the ladder. And as they compete to get up to the top of the ladder, the Karoshi ladder, the one at the very top who wins does what? The one who gets up to the top first does exactly what Aaron just said in the audience, he kills himself. Not in real life— in the game. Why is he killing himself? Because he's saying to himself, "I have lost myself as a human being in the process of becoming a human doing. I am the biggest human doing around, but I've lost my soul in the process. I've lost who I really am. And so, in essence, I've committed suicide."
- 3.44** And of course, in Japan, a great many of the men do not the committing of suicide necessarily, but they work six days a week. They often stay in the city in Tokyo. When I was doing one of my books in Tokyo, I'd see men just in large droves, going home on Friday and then staying in the city during the week, oftentimes with geisha girls or other people that can take care of their needs during the week, but missing their family enormously. And yet that was what was expected of them if they were to be respected. And so the Japanese youth are beginning to become wise to that, and they're saying, "There's something more to life than being a human doing. I want to be a human being and not commit suicide as a human doing."
- 3.45** Real life, you see this in two ways. One is the literal way of Junior Seau. I used to live in San Diego, and he was a major football star who committed suicide. Robin Williams, a quasi-friend/acquaintance who committed suicide. Anthony Bourdain and Marilyn Monroe, who doesn't need any introduction. However, this is really the minor type of

suicide, the suicide that is literal. But the real suicides that are happening all around are the suicide of the soul that the Japanese youth have identified with, that are not with the superstars, but are with the millions and millions of everyday men.

- 3.46** So men have learned a definition of power. And this is probably the most important sentence of this 3-day workshop. The men's definition of power is feeling obligated to earn money our family will spend when I die sooner. And I think we all agree that that's not a really good definition of power, but it is, in a sense, what I would call the paradox of male power. And it's what's missed when people say that men have the power.
- 3.47** That if I were to start a workshop on empowering women, and I would say, "Women, I'm going to teach you all how to earn money that someone else will spend while you die sooner." And so every woman would be intelligent enough to kick me out of the workshop before I went on to the second sentence. And it's because they would understand that that's obviously not the type of empowerment that they were coming into this workshop to get.
- 3.48** So to illustrate this, I'm going to do with you what I would call a "glint in the eye" experience. And so I'm going to ask you all just to close your eyes, if you would. I'm going to do a guided visualization with you. I'm going to ask you to find a time in your life when you noticed a glint in your dad's eye. That is, a time when he was completely joyful. When he was relaxed. When he was not focused on lecturing to you and telling you what you were doing wrong.
- 3.49** Maybe he was telling a favorite joke that he told over and over again, or a favorite story that he told over and over again. Maybe he had just come back from skiing. Maybe he was fly fishing, golfing, gardening, hiking. Maybe he sang in your local chorus. Maybe he acted in a local play. Maybe he painted, did a little bit of artwork, or maybe he painted years ago. Maybe he played in a band that he no longer plays in. Maybe he plays with your children. When he played with his children, he seemed so totally relaxed and so happy because he didn't feel he had the responsibility of correcting your children, just playing with them. Maybe he flew a small plane at sunset and just loved discovering when the sunset and timed the flight where he saw the beauty of the clouds and the sunset. It was like poetry to him. Maybe in that little plane, he could take you or his wife up and just have the joy of both performing and art integrated.
- 3.50** If you didn't know your dad, you lost your dad at a very early age, I'm going to be asking you to guess what might have been the glint in your dad's eye. I'm asking you to guess from little hints that maybe your mother gave you, somebody that knew your dad gave you, just things that were said about your dad. Make up what you think might have been the glint in your dad's eye. Because whatever you're making up is your image of your father, and that's part of your relationship with your father, even if you didn't know your dad.

- 3.51** I'm asking you to search for the glint in your dad's eye because I'm asking you to search for his soul, his spirituality, that glint was his unique self. That glint was what inspired him. If you feel you don't know, continue searching on a best guess. The best guess will give you the closest you can get to what you imagined your father to be like.
- 3.52** Now imagine your dad spending his entire life doing that glint. Painting, gardening, flying little planes, if you're old enough, playing with your children. Maybe you saw that in your grandfather when you had children just relaxing and playing.
- 3.53** I'm going to be asking you in a moment to think about that versus what your dad actually did. So you could open your eyes now. But I'll ask, so I'm going to be asking you in a moment to think about what your dad actually did for a living versus what created the glint in his eye. So if your dad is a pilot and he used to love flying small planes at sunset and watching the poetry of the clouds and the interaction of the sun, I'm going to ask you to not assume that your dad was doing what created the glint in his eye because flying a plane when you want to, how you want to with your wife or your children in the cockpit is a very different thing than obeying hundreds of FAA regulations, flying the same route over and over again, having responsibilities and doing that type of thing.
- 3.54** If your dad loved cooking at Thanksgiving, and he loved the pride of his family when the turkey was served and now he became a chef, don't assume that that is him following the glint in his eye. Cooking once a year at Thanksgiving creates a glint when you're serving your family. Cooking every day for strangers, and then at Thanksgiving, that takes you away from your family is quite a different experience. As any mom will say, any traditional mom will say, "The difference between cooking every day, and cooking once in a while is a very big difference."
- 3.55** And so I'll be asking you to sort of not make that mistake of assuming that the glint in his eye became his job when the job required things that were consistent and dependable and responsible all the time, versus the glint in his eye.
- 3.56** So now I'm going to ask you to do 3 things in your mind. 1, is to think about what your dad actually did for a living most of the time. 2nd, think about what created the glint in your dad's eye. Your best guess. And then 3rd, I'm going to be asking to share with me what makes that your best guess.
- 3.57** So now I'd like to ask you to close your eyes again for a very important part of this experience. Think of the number of children that your parents actually had. That is, your number of brothers and sisters that you had, or in woke terms, sentient, gender-fluid beings. Imagine your parents, when their first sentient being was born, accurately imagine that the number of children that they had was, that they actually did have, just assume that they were going to have about that number of children. And then they held that up to your dad's fantasy. And do you think that they thought that what your dad would make pursuing his fantasy could pay for each child's college, food, a larger

home in a good neighborhood with the best schools, doctors and dental bills that may or may not come up, insurance, monthly mortgage payments, etc.?

- 3.58** In a moment, I'm going to ask you to raise your hand if you believe your parents would have calculated that your dad's fantasy would have paid less than what he actually did for a living. Can I ask you to open your eyes and to raise your hand if you think that your dad's fantasy would have paid less, that they would have calculated that your dad's fantasy would have paid less than what was needed.
- 3.59** Almost always when there's an intuitive sense that if we want 2 or 3 or 4 children, that playing music might actually bring a decent living for a while, but it also has its ups and downs. You may lose your gigs. Being an artist, you might hit a top point, but then you may go out of fashion. Being an actor, you might have a great experience at one point, and that would offer you hope, but it could quickly go out of fashion. Actors—almost all in Los Angeles—actors have almost all the same name. They're called "waiter", and they're waiting for an acting experience. But everybody knows that you're up one day and you're down the next, except for about 1/2 of 1% of actors.
- 3.60** So the insights related to shaming male privilege, I want to share some of those now. The assumption of the past 50 years has been that men had the power and women didn't, as we talked about before. Here's the insight, that historically speaking, neither sex had power. Both sexes had roles. Women were told, no matter how talented they were, no matter who they wanted to be, that, "Your job, young lady, is to raise children." Men were told, no matter how much they wanted to be the artist, the musician, the actor, that "Your job is to raise money." As I was told by my dad, who in 1935 had come through two depressions and a world war. He was born in 1910, so you can imagine why he thought that way.
- 3.61** When you put all this together. For many and not all of our dads, our dads for the most part gave up the glint in their eye to make it more likely we would be able to discover the glint in our eyes. When I finally discovered that, and I told my dad, "Thank you for working so hard so that I could become an author and I could go up and down in my income." That's when he was settled inside of himself. That, "Okay, I had never looked at it that way. Thank you for acknowledging me." So I'm encouraging everyone who's listening to this to, if you have a dad that's still alive, call him, talk with him about that, and allow him to feel appreciated for that.
- 3.62** I did this experience once, some years ago, and at the time, I lived in San Diego. And I was on the streets and walking, and a young man came up to me, said, "Are you Walter Farrell? Or something like that?" I get, "Warren Farrell. Yes, I'm Warren Farrell." And he goes, "Oh, good. I attended that workshop you did where you asked about that 'glint in the eye' thing." And it was in, I guess, April or May, and so I decided for Father's Day, I would ask my dad, you know, "what was the glint in his eye?" And so he said, "I did that on Father's Day. And my father looked at me, and he said, "Yeah, Jimmy, you're still going to these new age workshops where you're learning all these airy-fairy things

about, what do I really want? What's the glint in my eye? And I just felt so angry at you, Warren. It's Warren, right? Not Walter?" "Yes." "

3.63 Okay and then he goes, 'Do you really mean that? About asking about what the glint in my eye is?'" And the young man said, "My dad started to cry. Understand, I've only seen my dad cry once in my life. When my mother passed away. I've never seen him cry before. And here he was crying at the same thing. He was just mocking me for even asking about. I said, 'Dad, what's happening?' He said, 'Jimmy, I didn't think that anyone would ever care enough to ask.'" That's part of the reason I'm asking you to call your dad if he's still alive. And to ask him about the glint in his eye.

3.64 The result of not knowing about this is our sons who are feeling shamed at themselves for being part of the, quote, patriarchy that made rules to benefit men, theoretically, at the expense of women. And I hope this experience gives us a sense of, "It wasn't quite that way. Both sexes worked their rears off."

3.65 Grandparents never talked about rights. They talked about responsibilities. My father once told me, "Warren, you're ruining the lives of millions of people." And I said, "How do you get that?" And he said, "You're teaching them psychology." And I said, "So what's there about psychology that's ruining the lives of millions of people?" And he said, "Because you're teaching people to do what they want to do, not what they have to do. Being a grown-up is giving up that glint in your eye." He didn't use "glint in your eye", but giving up doing what you want to do. To do what you have to do. That's what responsibility is about. That's what being a man is about.

3.66 He never had the opportunity to even consider the possibility of thinking about what he wants to do. So when we talk about women's rights, that wasn't our grandparents terminology. It wasn't the grandfather's terminology. It wasn't the grandmother's terminology. It was all about two things: R and O—responsibilities and obligations. And one of the big mistakes we made in the feminist movement, I said, we made because, as you know, I was on the board of NOW in New York City, that we made in the feminist movement was thinking that because men earned more money not for the same work, but because they earned more money for different work, that they therefore had the power, as opposed to understanding this much deeper definition of power, of being control over your own life.

Lecture 4: Unmasking Vulnerability

At a glance — Unmasking male vulnerability: myths about power and rule-making, and the hidden costs boys and men carry.

- 4.1 A couple of myths that emanate from the purpose void. Myth #1 is that men made the rules to benefit men at the expense of women. I hope it's really clear now that that's a myth. And that there's so many rules that men made outside the home and so many rules that women made inside the home. Both sexes made rules in the areas where they had responsibilities. And the men's rules were not made to benefit men at the expense of women.
- 4.2 A male-only draft registration is a law today. It is 100% constitutionally in violation of the Equal Protection Clause. However, conservative judges want to keep it because they believe that women shouldn't be at risk of death unless they choose to be. And Biden requested of the Supreme Court, "Please do not review that rule." And the Supreme Court just let it go. The separation of powers that is normally not supposed to lead to a president suggesting to the Supreme Court what to leave alone was nevertheless left alone because in Texas, the Supreme Court had ruled against that male-only draft registration being constitutional. And so it was moving up the ladder, the possibility of making male-only draft registration unconstitutional. And both conservatives and liberals reunited in their desire to prevent that from happening. And that's how deeply ingrained that we can have something that is so much in direct violation of the constitution, and yet it would not be questioned by either party.
- 4.3 We see the same in the Ukraine. In the Ukraine, every male between the ages of 18 and 60 must sign up to fight or to serve in some major approved way that is usually involving the risk of life, like being a medic and helping if you're not actually on the front line. Every female in the Ukraine is allowed to fight if she wishes to, but absolutely no requirement to fight. And it's about the options versus the obligations, the multi-option woman versus the no-option man.
- 4.4 All of which is to say that both sexes have their obligations and responsibilities, and we are tied to men making rules that even lead to the disposability of men without even questioning that, even when they're unconstitutional.
- 4.5 The 2nd big myth—and this is the myth that I was mentioning briefly a minute ago—that Jordan Peterson took an interest in when I wrote the book *Why Men Earn More and What Women Can Do About It*, which is 25 things. And I outlined 25 choices that men on average are more likely to make versus 25 choices that women are more likely to make around work/life balance.
- 4.6 All 25 choices that, statistically speaking, men are more likely to make, lead to men earning more at work. However, and all 25 choices that women are more likely to make lead to women having a more balanced life. So one of the themes of why men earn

more is that men, you need to be learning from women, because a more balanced life is usually the core ingredient of a more successful life. And a more successful life is what we all really want.

- 4.7 So let me go a little bit more deeply into that. We hear as part of that myth that men earn \$1 for each 79¢ a woman earns for the same work. It is true that men earn about \$1 for each 79¢ that women earn, but not for the same work. And what's true is that dads earn more than moms. Because when moms become moms and dads become dads, as a rule, women, even if they're working full-time, cut back on the number of hours they work full-time. So the US Bureau of Labor Statistics defines full-time work as 35 hours per week or more. So the woman is much more likely to cut back to about 35, 36, 37 hours per week if she has children. She's also much more likely to restrict where she works. So she's much less likely to commute far once she has children. Not a big issue and big difference. Before she has children, she'll commute. But once she has children, her primary job, many women interpret, is to make sure that the children are taken care of and she's not so far away from the children that if an emergency happens that she can't respond to that emergency.
- 4.8 The dad, however, starts commuting further once the children are born and therefore has a greater choice of jobs that are designed to earn more money because he now has responsibilities to earn more money. And so what I discovered is, I measured all 25 of these variables and hired statisticians to double-check me and work with me and found that when men and women do the same work for the same number of hours, for the same number of years at that job in the same specialty and subspecialty, they earn about the same.
- 4.9 Now, that is in contradiction with a lot of headlines that you see. So you might see a headline saying, "Male doctors still earn more than female doctors." And so from the average person's perspective, "Warren, you are so wrong because we're comparing doctors with doctors." However, doctors are not the same as doctors, meaning that some doctors are general practitioners and work for HMOs, and other doctors are cardiac surgeons and work 60, 70 hours a week and are on call whenever they need to be on call and have a totally different life. But when you start comparing cardiac surgeons to cardiac surgeons or the same type of doctor with the same subspecialty to each other. The pay gap shrinks to about this.
- 4.10 However, if 79¢ to \$1 is like that, the pay gap shrinks to about this. But from my perspective as Dr. Egalitarian, if men are earning 3 pennies more per hour for the same work, I go back to being a total feminist until it's equal. But it isn't equal. What ends up happening is even the two cardiac surgeons or the two women and men of any specialty, the women are more likely to have worked fewer years in that specialty, retire sooner in that specialty, they're likely to work for more likely to work for HMOs that allow them steady hours rather than unpredictable hours.

- 4.11 I taught at the School of Medicine at the University of California in San Diego, and I saw this start in the first year of medical school. The women were planning to be in professions like dermatologists or psychiatrists that had much more predictable hours, that were connected with people. The guys right from first year were planning to get into surgery and stuff with blood, and the women didn't want to be—a much smaller percentage of women wanted to be in the blood professions, as I called it—instead of handling blood and guts.
- 4.12 But when women do and men do, and they have the same profession, the same number of years, the same number of publications in that profession, to develop the same reputation, that's when women earn slightly more than men do for the same work. I cannot be sure how much more. I just know that it's 99% likely to be a little bit more. And probably the reason for that is, when we do find women working like that, a lot of people compete to get that percentage of women that do work that type of way, that leads to more work. But there's so many overlaps in the variables that you can't do perfect measurement of that.
- 4.13 And so that's very important to know, because the real, if you believe, if it were true that men earned more money than women did for the same work, that means that we were undervaluing women, and that's not okay. And so that's why that's such an important myth to clarify.
- 4.14 The number two thing to know about the pay gap is that, never-married women, never-married women who have never had children have earned 117% more than never-married men who have never had children. And women in that category exceeded men in that category and their earnings since the 1970s. Raise your hand if you've ever heard that. It's completely not in the literature yet. Anyone checking it out can see that from the US Bureau of Labor Statistics.
- 4.15 So what is there about never-married women who have never had children and never married men who have never had children? Never-married women who have never had children begin to get their act together, usually around their career. Their purpose is career, their life is career, and they do very well. Never-married men who have never had children, whether straight or gay, are oftentimes much more likely to say, to sense that they're going to not have children and to feel free to do careers that are more likely to match the glint in their eye, that is, to be the starving artist, to be the actor, to be the writer, to be the things that my father warned me about and to do that type of work. And so they tend, on average, never married men who have never had children to earn less and earn less than women do.
- 4.16 So it's important to know all of these things, because otherwise we go around with a hidden attitude of it's really a men's world created by men for the benefit of men at the expense of women. And any young man who's learning that begins to feel ashamed of himself and feel like he's part of the wrong party, so to speak, part of the wrong sex.

- 4.17 The other dimension of just thinking about that is thinking about capitalism. If you could hire a woman, if you could pay a woman less for the same work, who would hire a man? Capitalism is an incentive to not discriminate because you're paying more to pay more for somebody than when you could hire somebody else for less, is exactly the opposite that everything capitalism is about. Capitalism is about trying to get the greatest amount of work for the least amount of money. And if you don't do that, capitalism punishes you. The punishment is somebody else will do that and they will out and their product will be cheaper for the same quality. So in brief, these attitudes and myths about boys and men have led to our blindness to boys problems and our feeling that what's progressive is to pay attention to only girls and women's problems. And I would suggest that that's not progressive if it's not accurate.
- 4.18 I want to move on to Cause #4 of the Boy Crisis. This is a sad one, which is the fear of psychological attachment to someone we love, who we may lose. I'll explain. Images of a man going, men going off to war, and knowing on some level that he may never come back, and psychologically, when we feel that somebody may not come back, we can't allow ourselves psychologically to get too attached to that person. Being sensitive to male death, our survival is dependent basically on men's willingness to die. It always has been. To a lesser degree, it still is today. Being sensitive to male death competes with our survival instinct. Those are in constant tension with each other historically.
- 4.19 Here is the really big bad news, "Hero today, who cares tomorrow." So 4 veterans commit suicide at home for each soldier who is killed in the Iraq and Afghanistan wars combined. Here's what's behind that tragedy. So if we ask the question why the VA—the Veterans Administration—does three things extremely poorly. That if we cared about the men coming home, we would have made policies and be doing things very differently.
- 4.20 One is the way they handle PTSD. Almost every person who comes back from war has very severe experiences of, you would get close to somebody, and even if you're not killed yourself, you lose them. You begin to fear getting close to somebody because the last person you were close to, you lost or you saw his or her arm or shoulder just taken off and you begin to fear becoming close.
- 4.21 Plus, the army teaches you, the army teaches you to do a number of things. They teach you vertical communication. You either obey the person above you or you order the person below you. Now, which one of those two things works at home? Neither. So the process you learn to survive in war is exactly the opposite of the process you need to survive in love and to survive with your family. Family communication is about listening, interaction, getting feedback loops. It is not about either ordering around or just obeying somebody.
- 4.22 So the VA—the Veterans Administration—focuses rather after a war, if you have problems, the answer is medication, not education, not reeducating the style of communication that is so necessary to be redone, that is very important in war. In war,

if the sergeant says, "You know, all these Jews did this, and you're Jewish." And you're a soldier, you say, "Sergeant, sir, I'm Jewish, and I really didn't like that antisemitic comment." "Oh, Mr. Little Jewish boy, do you just want to do 5 push-ups? And let's see how that works. Can a Jewish boy do 5 push-ups?" And then he does 5 push-ups. "Well, maybe you need to do 25." And so the boy learns, no matter what comment bothers him or he's sensitive to, that the job of you in war is to get rid of your sensitivities because the war machine works better without squeaky wheels.

- 4.23 Your job is to become one cog in the war machine and just do what you need to do. Your job is not to be a human-being with sensitivities. Your job is to be a human-doing in war more than any other place. That's the bad news. The good news is that you sometimes learn some discipline from this. You learn how to handle things. You learn how to handle criticism better. And one level, you learn how to handle criticism better. On another level, it's going deep inside of you, and you feel the hurt and the pain, and you're not allowed to express it.
- 4.24 And when people come back, when mostly men come back from war, but also women who come back for more, they need to. The degree to which they've been exposed to violence and the degree to which they've gone up the ladder is the degree to which they need to have a permission for a new type of communication, not medication.
- 4.25 The 2nd thing is that the surviving men need to learn how to be reintegrated into the family. Most men, when they are at war and they have children, they are yearning for the day when they come home to be able to share with their children what they've learned. Usually they are much more disciplined. They've had a life of boundary enforcement, boundary enforcement, boundary enforcement. And they come home to a wife and a mother that's had a life of protecting the children, protecting the children. But in that difference, they see their mission. And I have something to offer. I can teach the children how know really be disciplined like I am because I went into war not so disciplined and I came out disciplined. I'm proud of that part of me, that part of me, even if he's unconscious of the other part that we just talked about.
- 4.26 But the military, the VA—the Veterans Administration—does not train people to work with their families, to reconnect in a way that can allow him to translate the best of what he learned in war and do checks and balance parenting with the mother who can contribute what she learned. Remember, the mother has gotten used to maybe two years of experience of just running a household. She has it down pat. She knows what she wants. And everything that the man suggests from her perspective feels like you're just not respecting, you're criticizing what I did for the last two years. That doesn't feel good to the woman who's spent and devoted all two of those years raising the children. When the situation is reversed and the men are caring for the children and the woman female military person comes home, that's often the same in reverse. So we need to work and pressure our VA to care more about that reintegration into the family.

- 4.27 And 3rd, almost every military person who feels like, "If I'm going to not go on another service mission, then I want to be able to do, I want to have a sense of purpose when I come home. I want a new mission. The new mission can be being a great dad, but it also can be helping other people. Almost all military people want to serve, and so it's very important that the Veterans Administration work on finding an alternative way of serving for the man that comes back. It can be serving with the family. It can be serving on helping other people, doing things for people who are poor. Integrating that with the work. The VA, once they're finished with the disposable part of men, they don't take care of the reintegration of men from human doings into human beings. And hence, you have this enormous amount of suicide among veterans, far more suicide than actually killed in battle itself.
- 4.28 On some level, almost every returning military person that I've spoken to has some of that feeling being harbored inside of him. And when you've been willing to give up your life to serve, and then you feel that the people who you serve, the country, does not care about you, that really eats a deep hole in your heart.
- 4.29 One way I mentioned before that men serve has been in the military. Another way is in what I would call the death professions, which is what I call men's "glass cellars". That 93% of the people who die at work are men. And I call that men's "glass cellars" or the death professions. It's not just construction workers. One construction worker dies every workday hour in the United States. There's been many improvements made by OSHA about restrictions and regulations that have improved the safety of men in most professions. But it's very fascinating. When I did the research on that issue, I found that a very high percentage of regulations, like the improvement of scaffolding on buildings, that the scaffolding had to be really constructed in a way that was stable, that withstood wind and things like that. They came about, for the most part, when the scaffolding, as an example, broke down and killed a female pedestrian. And so it's really our instinct to save women and not to pay attention to the deaths of men until a woman is hurt by the things that men do to make their own life less safe, is really quite fascinating. And I'm laughing, but obviously, I'm laughing because it's so sad that it is laughable.
- 4.30 Basically, the psychology of masculinity is the psychology of male disposability. And we create—to help make men disposable—we create social bribes, we give them medals, the more they risk their life, the higher the medal, the higher the positions, the greater the status. Being called "Hero" and being given all those medals, I call them social bribes to risk death.
- 4.31 This is not just a democratic thing. This is also a republican thing. We are united in one area in a world in which we have so many differences. One, unification is what I call "the United Social Bribes of America", is that both political parties are united in giving those social bribes to men more than women, to a much greater degree. Or I should

say, men by mandate or by the integration of those social bribes into their psychology, and women much more by choice.

4.32 There's another bribe that is much more subtle. It's Stephen Crane, when he wrote *The Red Badge of Courage*, identified this bribe, which is—he didn't call it this—but it was what I call "the brotherhood bribe". That brotherhood is more potent even than the cause for which they were fighting, he talked about during the civil war. The Brotherhood bribe is both internal and external. When we risk death for a purpose we believe in, we feel a sense of brotherhood with the other people that are risking that death with us externally. And then in addition to that, when that fight and that brotherhood defines us as a man, that's a combination of an internal and an external bribe. It's inside of our psyche, and we've in many, many ways been bribed to think that way.

4.33 During World War I, what was the bribe that women gave to men that did not participate in the war, even if they had some reason for not participating? If a man was at church, for example, in public, the women would give him a white feather. The white feather indicated that, "You're a coward." That was not given to men privately. That was given to men in places like church in public, to make sure that no man felt a freedom to opt-out of the process of being willing to die.

4.34 Externally, the more a country is threatened, the more the brotherhood bribe exists. It's likely to be used by the government and citizens to add a lot of external bribes, and also the external bribes of women, saying, "You must be a coward if you're here." The more dangerous the war, the more potent our enemy, the more we are encouraging people to move into the most dangerous areas of the military. The most dangerous area of the military, as you probably all know, is the Marines. And the Marines are more likely to die than in all other three services put together. And so the Brotherhood belief is very strong in the Marines. They call themselves a band of brothers. You probably saw, or some of you may have seen the 2001 miniseries called *the Band of Brothers* on the Marines, of course. So as the Marines are fighting, they feel that brotherhood and they believe that once a Marine, always a Marine. And so that is a social bribe to keep those men feeling connected to those who, in common with them, risk their lives to die.

4.35 This isn't just a US thing. Virtually all societies that survived throughout history survived based on preparing their sons to be disposable. Disposable in war, and if you're a developed nation, building up the infrastructure, the lumberjack job to build a house is among the most dangerous jobs on earth. Taking that lumber from the site of the lumber being cut down and major trucks across the country, that's another one of the most dangerous jobs. Building the home, the construction worker is another dangerous job, or building a bridge and being a welder is another one of the most hazardous jobs. All of these things that create what we have all around us. This building is built on the basis of the possible disposability of men.

- 4.36 And here's what oftentimes creates the PTSD. When you have a friend or you experience these types of results, notice this. Anyone remember this video? This was the video of Walter Scott in South Carolina a few years ago. This is a real video that a bystander took of a police officer shooting Walter Scott in the back and him dying. And what we protested about was, Black Lives Matter. He was black. It was a reasonable protest—Black Lives Matter. But the other half of this, of Walter Scott, was not just black, it was male. The degree to which we ignore male disposability, I think, can be seen in the fact that we only saw the part that was black, not the part that was male. Yet black males are 24 times as likely to be killed by police than are black females. That's why I say that the other half of the shooting was about not just being black, which I believe it was, in part, but also being male. And what was missed in the protest, that it was about killing a male and the permission that we have to have males be disposable. It goes deeper than that. Walter Scott was killed also because what he did, what was happening here, had a lot to do with being a male.
- 4.37 1/8 of all South Carolina inmates are in jail for being behind in child support payments. Walter Scott had been previously arrested for being behind in a child support payment, even though he was extremely poor and felt he couldn't make it. He told his brother, if I'm ever arrested for a child, stopped for a child support payment again, I'm going to run, because my time in jail was so miserable that he was willing to risk his life. Yet 3/4 of dads who were in prison in South Carolina, when studied by the commission in charge of studying that issue, they acknowledged that 3/4 of these dads were in extreme poverty. And yet 1/8 of all the prisoners in South Carolina were in jail because they were males who hadn't been able, in extreme poverty, to be able to pay child support. And yet it's very rare for a mom to go to jail for preventing a dad from spending enough time with his children, even though what children need from dad is time even more than a dad's dime, especially when there's no dimes available. And so one of the things that I have talked with legislators about is redefining child support as either dad's time or dad's dime, that either one of them should be able to be considered child support.
- 4.38 Let me move on to Cause #5 about that part of our issue is what we do when men do speak up, and the difference between a man speaking up, a woman speaking up, and a boy speaking up. We basically have as Cause #5, a real Repulsion for Males who Complain. When a man complains, a woman hears whining. Women fall in love with alpha men, not whining men. When a man complains, a woman feels oftentimes unprotected. When a man complains, a man hears someone for whom he loses respect.
- 4.39 I'll elaborate on that one for a moment. If a man complains to a man, basically the man who's listening gives him—I'm going to be generous now—up to about a three minute window of opportunity to air his stuff. After which we do what? We change the topic, "What about the game last night? Did you see that? Man, that was something. How's

your business, traveling doing? How are the kids taking on any new projects lately? Are you still involved with building those cars like that? That's really fascinating. I remember you were really into gardening." And if the other man who's complaining doesn't pick up the hint, that was a hint to end your complaining, young man or older man or whatever. And if he doesn't pick up the hint, let's say it's a colleague at work and he's talking with that colleague about it. That man will, first of all—no matter what the context is—the man listening to an extended complaint from another man will just begin to lose respect for that man.

- 4.40** If it's a man at work who's decided to open up and share about his personal life and he's having trouble with his marriage and maybe one of his children, and he's sort of maybe seeking advice or just empathy. When that man will—not only the man he's talking to—will not only lose respect, but when maybe that man is in a discussion with somebody about, well, we have a possibility for a promotion here with somebody. It's very likely to come, "You know, maybe not, Jim. He's going through a lot of problems at home." And so the man who complains talking to another man at work fears that not only is he not going to be heard and that somebody will lose respect for him, but also his family will lose respect for him because unlike the other people at work, he did not get a promotion. And what's the matter with him? So he feels multiple levels of disrespect happening. That makes his already great propensity to not express feelings and fears. If you really want to be a man, that reinforces that on an everyday level.
- 4.41** When a man complains, both sexes hear this. When a man complains, both sexes basically hear nails scraping on a chalkboard. It's one of the more awful feelings or sounds. When a woman complains, a man hears an opportunity, an opportunity to rescue her, or an opportunity to be "rewarded", quote unquote, with, ideally with sex, if he's an immediate gratification person, or love if he's a long-term gratification person. But one way or the other, he feels an opportunity. When a woman complains. I have no statistical data on what happened with this man after he rescued her.
- 4.42** There is one context in which it's okay for a male to complain. When a boy complains, a mom feels an instinct to protect. That's why many people told me when I wrote the Boy Crisis, "Warren, you can't write anything empathetic to men. Nobody will buy it. You'll be looked at as a misogynist, etc. etc." And yet, I have found that even feminist mothers who have a propensity to think that men have all the privileges and women don't. When a feminist becomes a mother of a son and she has about 12-13 years of taking care of him, she begins to see a pull. When she talks about guys taking sexual initiatives with her. She'll have lots of stories of adult men taking sexual initiatives with her, who were jerks, who lied to her, who tried to ply her with drinks, who tried to do a number of things, especially if she was an attractive woman growing up. She'll have a lot of men as jerk stories. She'll have a lot of stories about men over exaggerating and then not following through and so on. All of which will have sometimes a grain of truth, sometimes a lot of truth.

- 4.43 But when a boy, "Mom, I want to call Krista. But she's so popular, she'll never want to have anything to do with me." That's when a mom's heart starts to feel differently about a boy. She sees for the first time the fears of rejection that every male experiences in the process of asking any woman out, especially a woman that's attractive. And if mom says "No, no, I'm sure Krista will be happy to hear from you." "Oh, Mom, she hears from everybody at school. She's the most popular girl in school. There's no way she could want me." "Oh, Sweetie, you don't know. Sometimes when I was a girl, I was wait and wait and wait for somebody to ask me out and they wouldn't call at all. And I felt really bad about that. And then you know something? I went to a high school reunion and a guy told me that he had wanted to ask me out for the whole of high school and he had never done so because he was afraid of doing so. You know, just try it. Maybe Krista really will find something wonderful about you because I think you're one of the most wonderful young boys your age."
- 4.44 And so she's now beginning to open her heart to the fears of rejection that males experience when they risk rejection. And the feeling that not only do they have to risk rejection, but if the Krista says, "'I don't think I'm interested,' maybe you could offer Krista an opportunity to maybe as that boy gets older to go to maybe see something about ice skating because she's interested in ice skating. Figure out what Krista likes and then maybe take her to something that she really likes." "Oh, okay. So if she said, "No," maybe it's because I didn't offer her the right opportunity and so I'll go back and try again." And so the mother is suddenly beginning to understand that maybe every "No" doesn't mean "No" forever. Maybe some "No's" mean "No" until the female sees that there's enough interest on the part of the male to be able to pay attention to what her desires and needs are. And he comes back and has the strength to offer again.
- 4.45 Instinctively what women know is if a man who she says "No" to backs off forever right away, that that's not a good man to marry because he'll be a salesperson who, the moment he gets a "No" is likely to back off right away. And there's no salesperson she knows who when they hear a "No" back off right away, they figure a better way around. And so when a boy complains, mothers begin to experience those complexities in a way that they're not allowed to hear when they hear, "What is there about 'No' that you don't understand."
- 4.46 As they work with me, if they do, I work with them on understanding that there's a huge amount about "No" that is not understood. Does "No" mean "No" forever? You rejected, I reached out to hold your hand and you pulled it away. Does that mean—that's a clear "No" from my perspective—so does that mean "No" forever? "Don't ever try to hold my hand again." Does it mean "No" till the end of the date, and then, "I'll make a decision whether I want a second date with you and then you can try again." Does that mean "No" until you talk more about me and less about yourself? Does that mean "No" mean "No" until you talk more about yourself, so I don't understand who you are and less about me? Does that mean "No" until I have another glass of wine and

relax a bit more? Does that mean "No" until I have a cup of coffee and wake up? Does that mean "No" until you put on some music that I like? Does that mean "No" until you put on some music that's not just romantic immediately, but it's fast music followed by romantic music? Or maybe it should be romantic music followed by fast music.

4.47 Those are the things that men don't know about "No" until they experience that. And each of those from the man's perspective is another possibility of being rejected at that next level. And from the woman's perspective, she's watching how the man handles the rejection. Does he handle it with grace? Does he handle it with I'll back off forever? Does he handle it with trying again?

4.48 And so all of these things are not part of our male/female dialog. All of these things need to be part of our male/female dialog. And especially we talked about HR versus HER, some of these things happen at work, and people will often say, well, you don't really want to be involved dating with somebody at work. But a very high percentage of single women who work, who get married, marry somebody at work. And they marry somebody at work, usually who is above them, not below them, or at least at the same level that they are. And yet that's a setup for being kicked out of work, for dating somebody below you at work economically. And so all of these things need to be discussed in a way that doesn't assume the man who asked is either it's part of a courtship or it's part of a law court.

4.49 Many men say to me, "I really resent the comment this 'toxic masculinity.'" And I say, "Don't resent it. A lot of masculinity is toxic, but it's not toxic masculinity because of male privilege. It's toxic masculinity that emanates from male powerlessness or the male—by powerlessness, I mean the mandate that men have to repress their feelings rather than express their feelings. And the problems with feelings that are repressed is that when you repress your feelings, you're repressing vulnerability. After a while, you stuff it, and you stuff it, and you stuff it, and eventually it comes out as anger and no one understanding that, basically, anger is vulnerability's mask.

4.50 One of the core concepts that I work with in the couple's communication work I do, is that every time you hear your partner be angry, look for your partner's vulnerability. You will almost always be able to find it. The problem is that when the vulnerability is repressed and the anger is expressed, anger is responded to with anger. When you share your vulnerability, vulnerability is responded to with empathy. It's a much better path to better relationships and a better life.

4.51 Let's take a look at that for a moment with the mass shooters. Do you remember the letter I read from you, from Carlos, and all of the vulnerability there? Had he followed through in that mass shooting, there would have been nothing but anger toward him, and in some ways justifiably. But almost no one looks beyond that he was a hurt boy. And the boys who hurt us are almost always hurt boys. And that's part of the reason for that, is the core message is to men, if you have those feelings, repress them, then let

them stuff up, express them, and then everybody will respond to you with anger at your anger and not empathy for your vulnerability.

4.52 I would say that our next evolutionary shift is becoming conscious of male vulnerability. This is really where we need to be going from there. And this is where we have never been before. And this takes not only women listening differently, it takes men having the courage to speak up. It has men having the courage to be ostracized. I could not be hired at any major university in the United States for saying the things you've heard in the last two days. That's how dangerous talking this way is.

Lecture 5: Solutions

At a glance — Solutions — personal, community, and family-level — for addressing the crisis.

- 5.1** Today, we're going to look at solutions. And the solutions are going to be both personal, they're going to be connected to the community, connected to schools, connected to political, national politics as well. Because really, all of this has to change. All of this is what has led to the evolution of women in the last half-century. And the reverse of that meaning, not the reverse of it, but boys and men also making progress and becoming really, in a sense, equal in many respects to girls and women, which has not happened in the last half-century. All of these levels of solutions need to be accounted for.
- 5.2** And so the first solution that we'll look at is dads—children vs. work. So the question that often comes to mind, and people often ask me is, "Are men really interested in being involved in the fathering process to that degree? Aren't they just interested, don't they define themselves through work?" And so, for the first time in history, as far as I know, the Pew Research Center—probably the most respected research center in the country—actually asked dads what they want. Amazing! They asked them what they wanted, and they were shocked when they found out that 49% of dads said—these were dads who were working full-time—said they would actually prefer to be full-time with their children. Now, this is not taking dads that are unemployed and asking them this question, or dads that are working part-time and asking them this question. These are dads that are working full-time and asking them whether they'd prefer to be home full-time with the children. And 49% said yes, they wanted to be. That would be their preference, but the family needs the income. So they were putting the needs of the family above the needs or the desires of themselves.
- 5.3** The importance of that is that that means that there is a huge supply of fathers out there who are working, that are fine with being flexible and working at home, in fact, they'd prefer that if that income was available. So let's look at that. Now, today, 16% of women who are married are earning more than their husbands, and 34% are earning about the same as their husbands. So I often hear from women, "Life is really unfair. Men can be have-it-all men, but women can't be have-it-all women." Raise your hand if you've heard somebody say something like that before.
- 5.4** And so when I talk to women about that, I say, "Actually, you can be a have-it-all woman. You can be a have-it-all woman if you choose to marry a father who is more the nurturer, the nurturer type, and you are open to having him work full-time from home or at least be a primary caretaker. He might be working on some type of entrepreneurial project that may or may not succeed from home or doing something freelance and flexible from home, but his job is as a primary caretaker. It's your job to select for those men, as opposed to selecting for men that are breadwinner types already. But that involves women taking an important role in the selection process."

- 5.5 When women select for men rather than having men select for them, A—things work better because a happy wife is a happy life, as we talked about yesterday, in many respects. And secondly—it allows women original choice power rather than veto power. When you, Olympia, if you were a single woman—you are a single woman—and you only waited for men to come up to you. You tend to select for the type of men who are able to handle rejection and therefore toughen themselves to the feelings of rejection. And so they're more likely to be entrepreneurial types, but they've also been with many, many other women who have rejected them at first and they've overcome the rejection and so on. And you select for a different type of man. That man is not likely to be a nurturer/connector type of man. He's likely to be a provider/protector type of man.
- 5.6 So by not taking charge as a woman of who you want, you exercise not original choice power, which is real power, but you exercise only veto power. And you oftentimes, as a result of exercising that veto power, you start compromising. I find out if I'm single man, I find out from you that you really like to see a special type of concert. I get tickets to that concert. I say, "Well, I have tickets to that concert. Do you want to go with me?" "Well, all right," you don't have any interest in me, let's say, but you want to go to that concert, and "This person has tickets, and it's next Saturday, and that would be all right. So there's nothing big that's going on." But then I start sucking you in to a possible relationship with me. But you only have veto power there. And in a way, you give yourself less than veto power because you allow yourself to be sucked in to something that you want.
- 5.7 And so oftentimes women end up choosing men that are not the type of man that they really want, and they select for men that are not potential being full-time fathers. Now, I'm not advocating for a full-time dad. I'm just advocating for a woman who wants to be a have-it-all woman—have-it-all means, "I want to be fully involved with my career. I don't want to worry about glass ceilings. I want to be able to penetrate and get to the very top. I'm really motivated like that."
- 5.8 My wife is a woman who is very much like that. She owns a public relations firm, and she really is motivated—she loves work and is excited by work. But that type of woman can be a have-it-all woman if she selects for the type of man who isn't interested in being involved with the family and maybe working from home, maybe not, depending on what the situation is. But she's okay with that. Now, what I just said is, "She's okay with that." That's a euphemism for that marriage will predictably fall apart if she doesn't have one thing for that man—starts with an R—anybody want to guess?—Respect. If she doesn't respect him for not earning as much or more as somebody at the workplace, and if they go to a party and she's flirting with the CEO or the president or some major entrepreneur, he will feel that energy from her change. When he sees her flirting with that entrepreneur, he will not feel respected. There'll be tension between them. And those marriages usually do not last.

- 5.9** Choosing to be a have-it-all woman means choosing that type of man and having respect for him and honoring him as she would a CEO or some type of major entrepreneur. And that's the way to advance toward more flexibility that I'll talk about more in a minute. So the fascinating thing about the Pew Research Center is, again, this is the first time in history, that I'm aware of, that men were even asked the question, "What do you want?"
- 5.10** Compare that with what we've been doing with and for women, which I, as you know, completely agree with for the last half-century. As we've been saying to women, "What do you want?" You saw the powerpoints on the multi option woman and the theoretically multi option man—work full-time, work full-time, work full-time. But we've been saying to a woman, when you have a child, if you're married and middle class or above, you have 3 options. Option 1: work full-time. Option 2: children full-time. Option 3: do some combination of the both while the husband sits by and says, "Well, I have 3 options, too: work full-time, work full-time, work full-time."
- 5.11** So we've been tailoring choices to the type of personality a woman is, which is wonderful, but we haven't even been asking that question of a man in the last years. Think about how many of those choices that are all around us—the pill. There's a pill for women, but there is not a pill for men. We hear women have the "right to" children. Men have to "fight for" the children, the choice, the "right to" versus "fight for". We hear that lots of things about, "You go girl," or "Women's body, women's choice." We hear nothing about some equivalent of that for men.
- 5.12** Now I'm encouraging the era of an evolutionary shift to asking both sexes what they want to be so that as parents, we can discover the unique selves of both our daughters and our sons and not just do what we did with, do what we in the future, what we did with women in the past, which is say, "You're women: raise children. You're men: raise money." That is a false dichotomy that we used to have to choose to survive. We now, in nations where that are developed that are not so survival focused because they've had most survival needs are met, sometimes even poorer people have iPhones, things that people, 25, 30 years ago when I grew up, couldn't even conceive of.
- 5.13** I also want to make it clear that another thing is needed to make this happen. I said yesterday that anybody who feels that something doesn't work for them needs to take responsibility and speak up. And men have not spoken up. And I have to say men haven't spoken up in the framework of what we saw yesterday about when a man does speak up. And four or five men came up to me yesterday after the class, we talked about what happens when a man speaks up. He feels that most people see it as complaining. They lose respect for him. Women see it as whining. They are not turned on by whining men. They're turned on more by alpha men. And so all of these factors make it complex and challenging for men to speak up. And, having said that, I challenge men to speak up.

- 5.14** I was, as you know, involved at the beginning of the women's movement. And a lot of women feared that they would be called dykes and lesbians in a day when dykes and lesbians was not an acceptable thought to have. Rather, it was something that we discriminated against. And they feared that if they spoke up and they were too assertive, they would be condemned in that type of way, and they were. And that's when I felt that it was really important to support resisting that—being criticized for speaking up and saying who you want to be. Now, again, the same thing we need to do for men.
- 5.15** The next is a dad's time vs. dad's dime. A Harvard University study, one of the biggest longitudinal studies ever done—it's an 85-year longitudinal study. It's been around for longer than I have been. They found that people who, that men or women who provided between \$50,000- \$70,000 worth of money for a family of 4 or fewer, that once that \$50,000-\$70,000, depending on where in the United States you lived, was coming into the family, that a dad's dime became more important than a dad's time. They didn't put it that fancy way, but that's my wording of that, basically. And that the time with the father helps the family more than the money, than additional money being produced. The first \$50,000-\$70,000, \$80,000, that's needed for survival. That's what has controlled the world up until recently.
- 5.16** So if Dad-deprivation is the primary cause of the boy crisis, the primary solution is Dad-involvement. But Dad-involvement is a lot more complex than just saying, "Let's involve dads." So the question there is, "How do we create this solution of Dad-involvement?" And the first is knowing the value of Dad. And I hope yesterday I've made it really clear some of the parameters that create the value of Dad. And dads need to know that they are needed. This is particularly true if you're a biological mom and you have a biological father in the mix, but you maybe are divorced and you're not currently living together. And so the biological dad is often somebody from whom you're alienated in that type of circumstance. He needs to know that even if you're alienated from him, that you let him know that he is needed. Needed is part 1. And remember about men being, knowing that they're, needed.
- 5.17** Men, every generation has had its war. When Uncle Sam said, "We need you to fight in that war," men were willing to die when they were told that they were needed. That's core to men's biology— willingness to die. So if men are willing to kill and be killed in exchange for serving when they are told they are needed, men are willing to love and be love as a way of serving if they're told they're needed. So they need the biological mom to say, "I need you."
- 5.18** But anytime you're told anything that comes close to an appreciation, it really helps to be more specific. Not just to say, "I need you," but to also say, "Here is why I need you. You know, I thought that roughhousing you were doing was dangerous. I now have read about what roughhousing brings to child raising. I've read about the fact that it leads to things like empathy. I never would have thought that roughhousing would lead

to empathy done the way dads typically do it. I never thought that other things that you do as a dad, like teasing. I thought the teasing was cruel on your part, but I now see that teasing helps the child be able to take in a criticism without taking it so personally. As long as you're around, able to love him more frequently. I thought that when you teased him and he or she started to cry, that you were just an insensitive dad. I see it now that there is a way that it could be insensitive, but the way that you did it usually was a positive. As long as the child has enough time to be loved by you. And with you only spending one or two days a week with the child and then teasing him. In that context, teasing can be bad, but in the context of the child knowing that she or he is loved by you, that allows for teasing, a certain amount of it, to be a positive. I didn't know that before."

- 5.19 And when dads hear that the things that they were rejected for, they were criticized for in the past, and they are told they are needed and wanted, they'll come back into a child's life without having to come back into the woman's life, which, if you're divorced, you may not want that to be part of the situation. My current wife, the woman I met 30 years ago, the father of her two daughters, had left and was remarried and then got divorced again. And she had a part of her home built on, and she moved him back into the home in that part of the home, and it wasn't a big home, so that he could be more involved with the children. The children had—before he got remarried again—the children really did benefit from that re-involvement, and it required a little bit on my part to accept that as well. But I saw the benefit to that.
- 5.20 And boys who live with their fathers after divorce—that's after divorce, note—tend to be warmer, more mature, more independent, have higher self esteem. And worldwide, not just in the United States, the amount of time a father spends with his child leads to a greater amount of empathy on the part of the child toward others, for reasons I hinted at yesterday, and I'll contribute more to that today.
- 5.21 So dads need to know that moms know not just the things that they do, like roughhousing and coaching and so on, but exactly what those things that dads tend to do—like the roughhousing and the coaching—and how they create a bond with the child and how that bond allows the dad leverage to do things like criticizing, and have the child feel that nevertheless, despite the criticism, dad is on my side. Allow the child to be beaten at a game and take the loss without crying, without protesting, without getting into a big temper tantrum about the loss. These are all things that we need to let dads know that we know are part of their contributions, typically speaking.
- 5.22 And obviously with every contribution I'm making, sometimes moms, and especially single moms, can be doing the same types of contributions for their children, and are extremely, oftentimes, as I said at the outset, are among the most devoted and hardworking and overwhelmed people in the world, at least among the people that I have met in my life. We need to let moms and dads know that the involvement of dads,

predictably speaking, is by far the most important single factor in preventing kids from getting into drugs.

- 5.23** The involvement of dads is also the most important single, predictable factor in preventing children from committing suicide. So what we really have is a potential. I mentioned at the outset that one of the problems that caused the boy crisis is a purpose-void. That boys had their old senses of purpose go to war and possibly be disposed of in war, or go to work and either be disposed of physically, or climb the ladder and un-become a human being and become a human doing instead of a human being. Those were the old ways of disposing of men.
- 5.24** And the good news is we're disposing of men less that way, especially in the war way. But the bad news has been the purpose-void. And so there's a new possibility for a sense of purpose out there, and one of those is being a much more involved father. So in the future, the one thing that's predictable is that technology is going to bring us changes, especially AI, that are so fast and so powerful that none of us can possibly keep up with it. But one of the things that is predictable is that careers, when my father was an accountant, his career lasted a lifetime, and most grandfathers and so on, their careers lasted a lifetime.
- 5.25** Today, careers are likely, people are likely to have 3, 4, 5 careers. The great majority of people, only 25% of people who take a major in college, actually work in an area that is a derivative of that major. And so there's huge amounts of changes that are going to occur in careers. Careers will be shorter lasting, but life will be longer lasting, and therefore, being a dad will be longer lasting, while careers are shorter lasting. We lead to communicate that to dads, because dads oftentimes think in terms of, "Oh, yeah, I know that AI is going to make things change quickly," but they don't often look at, "Well, what will last a lifetime?" I've never heard of anybody saying that, "My dad, on his deathbed said, 'I wish I spent more time at the office.'"
- 5.26** I promised yesterday that I would both deal with solutions that went beyond also biological dads and the biological dad—before I do go beyond the biological dad, though— I want to share some of the differences between a biological dad and a surrogate father. I guess the best way to do that is to talk for a minute about my wife adopted a daughter at the age of two days in her former marriage with the man that I just mentioned, and when she adopted him, I got involved with Liz about 30 years ago when she was about 6 years of age. And I had just come back from a speaking tour in New Zealand. And somebody was coming over from New Zealand who was a rancher and had dinner with us. And obviously we asked her to come to dinner with us.
- 5.27** And I said to the rancher, "What's your favorite day on the ranch?" And he said, "Well, actually, I guess it was really fascinating. We had 12 ducklings, and the mom and dad duckling were killed. And amazingly, a chicken took over the raising of the ducklings. And just watching that chicken take over the raising of the ducklings and the love and the devotion of that chicken to the ducklings was just fascinating.

- 5.28** And then one day the ducklings were big enough to be able to waddle out of the barn, and—I don't just walk this way because I'm this age—but they waddled out of the barn and the chicken, of course, followed them and they went down the hill and we have a lake at the bottom of the hill, and the ducklings just jumped right into the lake, all 12 of them, and the chicken went berserk! And what do you do? You're going to drown. You're going to drown. How can you do that?!"
- 5.29** My daughter Erin said, "That's exactly the way I feel every day. I feel like a duck. I feel like a duck raised by a chicken." That was obviously very powerful for me to hear. But it's an example of the power of the biological parent, that as much as my wife was devoted to taking care of her and her biological daughter, she sensed that something in her was different than what her parents, what the adopted mother had to offer.
- 5.30** And when a child looks in the mirror, especially if they hear that one of the parents is being badmouthed, what they see in that mirror is themselves as half of the parent that's being badmouthed, the hair, the nose, the eyes. And when we badmouth the other parent, the other biological parent, that's really one of the worst forms of child abuse. When I talk about badmouthing, I'm not just talking about badmouthing that children can directly detect word for word. I'm also talking about tones of voices that children overhear from another room when you're on the phone with a friend that indicate and give the child the hint that that other parent that's being talked about is something's wrong with him or her.
- 5.31** The child can't talk about that to the parent that's doing the badmouthing, because in a divorced situation, the child's already feeling very insecure and feels that if they mention that to that parent, that that will create a conflict with the parent, that will increase the insecurity, or if they mention that to the parent that's being badmouthed, that that will get back to the original parent that did the badmouthing, and that will increase the destabilization that they're already feeling badly about, which is why I feel that badmouthing is one of the most important forms, one of the most negative forms of child abuse.
- 5.32** But having said that, if we've made the effort to get the biological dad involved for one reason or another, that might be impossible. The biological dad might be dead, might be in prison, and may not be able to get out of prison soon enough, etc. And so what about a stepdad? Stepdad is a very good possible surrogate dad, possibly. But under the great majority of circumstances, there's a dynamic between the stepdad and the biological mom, which goes something like this.
- 5.33** The stepdad is likely to do boundary enforcement or teasing or roughhousing or allow the child to be at a basketball game and then leave the child at that basketball game and come home and watch the football game while the child's at the basketball game. All of those things are hints to the biological mom— or feel to the biological mom—like, "He didn't stay with the child at the basketball game because he was more interested in football than in watching the child. He was roughhousing with the child. Then my son or

daughter got hurt because he doesn't really care that much about the daughter or the son as I do." So all the things that moms tend to do in terms of protecting when they see that the stepfather, is not as involved in the protecting mechanism or the protecting modality, as much as the mom is, are interpreted when it's a stepfather as something that is really a result of not, "Caring as much about the child as I do," as opposed to that, "This is part of the positive contribution of dads."

- 5.34** And because we haven't educated the public as to what the positive contributions of dads are, the mom can't get that information from other women, from men, from the culture as a whole. And so that oftentimes leads to the stepfather never becoming more than an advisor. Whereas the really best stepfather relationship is one where the mom is not just taking the stepfather's advice and listening to it, and then following her instinct, but is working out a checks and balance arrangement between the mom and the dad with treating the dad as if he had equal power or equal responsibility. And the more we treat him as if he has equal responsibility, the more he will take what? — equal responsibility. Because everybody participates to the degree to which they feel needed and wanted.
- 5.35** Church leaders, no matter what religion you believe in, whether you are Protestant, Catholic, whatever, I encourage you to find— and I have seen the benefits of—finding a church leader—whether it's a minister, a priest, a rabbi, or an imam—finding a church leader who aligns to some degree with your faith. If you're less oriented toward God, finding, doing, maybe a Unitarian church, and checking out the church leaders based on your sense of that church leader's compassion, involvement, comfort with kids, and responsibility and non-abusive tendencies. And then talk to him or her about forming a group of kids, boys your son's age, and then having the boys share with each other the feelings and the fears that they have.
- 5.36** So every boy has—there's a film by Ashanti Branch, *BRANCH*, that has boys sitting around in a group in school, and they all are given a mask. And on one side of the mask they write and they paint a picture of how they portray themselves to the other at school or to the friends who are boys. On the other side of the mask. They write how they really feel inside of themselves. And as we could probably all guess, on the outside, I appear confident. I feel very masterful. On the inside, I feel insecure. I feel I'm not as good as other people are. I feel that I'm too short, I'm too fat, I'm too this, I'm too that. And they tap into all their insecurities, and then they take the mask and they throw the mask into the center of the group.
- 5.37** In that center of the group, everybody picks out a mask without knowing whose mask they're picking out. No one has to say whose mask is in the group. And so then the boys start reading out the insecurities, and it turns out that almost every boy has exactly the same mask on the outside and exactly the same fears on the inside. And once 1 or 2 or 3 people begin to say that, every boy becomes free to say, actually, that's mine, that's mine, that's mine. But they're also very so similar to everybody else's that sometimes

the boys get mixed up as to whether that is theirs or that is somebody else's in the group.

- 5.38** But what that does for every boy is to lead him to realize that "my insecurities are not what I think they are. They are not me, inferior. They are not me, hopeless. They are not me, a loser." And so the boy walks around with a type of confidence and yet not arrogance, that is very beneficial to him.
- 5.39** That's the value of finding a good church leader who will do that type of setting up of a group. And that group has to be strictly—and the church leader needs to know this—has to be 100% confidential. And it has to be really clear that the moment a discussion of the individual boys in that group is talked about by another member of the group, that's the reason for expulsion from that group. So your son feels completely safe opening up and getting in touch with his insecurities and recognizing that his insecurities are pretty much just the same as everybody else's insecurities.
- 5.40** One of the wonderful things that women have been doing since the 50 years that I've been involved in this issue, is forming these awareness groups, these consciousness-raising groups that I mentioned on the first day that got me involved here. And so since that time, I've formed some 300 men's groups and some 250 women's groups. I went around every place that I spoke. I would pass out a pad and ask women to sign or men to sign, and then I would spend till one in the morning after I got, made peace with the janitors, and got them to learn how to run a men's group or a women's group.
- 5.41** Another important way of having a surrogate dad is a coach. Get your son involved in sports. Not just sports, but what I would call the liberal arts of sports. The liberal arts of sports are both organized sports that have structure and leadership, but also in pickup games. It's very powerful to be involved in a pickup game because that teaches you to be an entrepreneur.
- 5.42** If I'm in a pickup game and I see Gabriel and I say to myself, "Okay, he's tall. He's somebody I want to have on my team, or he's so tall and good, and I make myself out to be that way. And I choose teams, and we're figuring out how to put our team together." That's the beginning of a training to be an entrepreneur. Then we negotiate full-court, half-court. Then we begin to feel out each other about what's a foul. Should I train my team to have fouling practice? Do I allow drinking on the court? And so we begin to create all the parameters and the rules from the start, as opposed to organized team sports, where somebody else makes those rules for us.
- 5.43** Organized team sports are wonderful preparation to be in a corporation or an organization. But pickup team sports are wonderful preparation for being able to create your own thinking, start organizing and becoming an entrepreneur. And then there's also sports like tennis or gymnastics, where you have a team, but the primary effort is for you to do your own discipline.

- 5.44 Or a cheerleader, you have a team, but you go, "1st and 10 do it again!" As a cheerleader, you're learning to do the kicks and you're learning to do the somersaults and whatever there is. "Wow, did I do that?" You're learning all those things to be for yourself and the discipline has to be within you. But you do contribute indirectly to a team, and that's what I call the liberal arts of sports. What should you get your son involved with? All 3 of them, because each one teaches a different skill set and each of them usually has with it 1, 2 or 3 coaches.
- 5.45 So I encourage any single mom to approach, to spend some time at the games or the events and to sense the coaches that she feels are most kind, but yet also most boundary enforcement oriented, that are pushing your son to new types of disciplines, new types of creativity, without being cruel. And then begin to ask that coach directly, say to that coach, "I really see these qualities in you. We don't have a biological dad at our home. Would you just every once in a while, spot what Jimmy is doing well and just acknowledge him for it? Spot what Jimmy is doing not so well and talk to him about it, but not in front of the group, just taking him away one-on-one and isolating him and just talking about it in a tone of voice that shows love and concern and caring about him after you have found things that are good about him." And so most coaches, especially if selected by a mom for those qualities, are more than happy to have that purpose added to their purpose. So you're creating a gift for the coach and a gift for your son.
- 5.46 It's also very important to get involved—let me work with the church leaders for a while. One of my most powerful experiences with a church leader was in Bedford-Stuyvesant. That's just one of the poorest parts of the country in Brooklyn, New York. And I was asked to speak to, it was a 100% African American audience, and it was a very large group. I remember walking down the aisle and then coming back to the podium and seeing on the podium a 5' version of Jesus who was all black. And then afterwards, the church leader took me back to meet with 32 boys, 8 boys from each of 4 young men's groups that he had started. Of those 32 boys, about 28 of them had been in prison.
- 5.47 About 24 of the 28, as I talked to each boy around the group, said they would still be in prison if they hadn't been, if they haven't had a belief in God the father, and if the minister, this particular minister, had not singled out each one of them and talked to them about their strengths, about their potential, and also about what they needed to do to improve that. These boys, the ones that benefited so much, needed two surrogate fathers, God the father and the minister, as father. And both of them had, according to the boy's own testimony, a huge impact on these boys' lives. So whether you believe in God or the church, the institution that support that surrogacy can be helpful. No matter what your belief system is.
- 5.48 Grandfathers, grandpas can be of enormous help. Remember that President Obama did not have father involvement, but his grandfather was very involved. He testifies that

that was very helpful to him in having a positive male role model. And at the same time, we need to know that grandpas can often have a two-generation -old vision of the world that has to be sort of worked with both with direct contact with the grandpa, because something that might have been extremely helpful in Grandpa's day, when survival controlled what Grandpa thought and did, might not be as helpful today, where discovering one's unique self might be more viable than it was in Grandpa's time. And we've seen that difference even with my father versus me and how my father was very much relieved when I understood that his sacrifices had led to my freedom, that he had never even thought, that he had not considered.

- 5.49** Another 2 areas that are sometimes missed is scouting and boys' clubs. Boys' clubs are really very dominant or predominant in inner city communities and are very helpful to boys. When I was a counselor for a boys' club, I remember going from the inner city of Newark, New Jersey, out to a rustic area for our camp and one of the boys on the bus going, "What's that? What's that? What's that?" And the other counselor and I are going, "What do you mean, what's that? It's like a field."
- 5.50** And the other boys were saying, a couple of the other boys were also saying, "What's that? And we just couldn't understand what was happening there. And finally one of the boys said, "Do you mean the cow?" The boys had never seen a cow before. Once we pointed it out, they recognized it from something in the movies or something, but they just were not able to pick out a real-life cow in a real-life field. And the boys' clubs are really good at getting boys out of the inner city and immersing them in nature. And we talked yesterday about the importance of the immersion in nature and what happens to boys and girls when they are immersed in nature, that type of way. So that's boys' clubs.
- 5.51** Scouting—a huge study was done of Cub Scouts. I'll start with them. And the study measured six different character development dimensions of the Cub Scouts, rather. One was trustworthiness, another was hopefulness. Another was kindness. Another was obedience. Another one was helpfulness. Another one was cheerfulness. At the end of, so they had control groups, boys that did not participate in Cub Scouts, boys who participated in Cub Scouts but very rarely, and boys who participated in Cub Scouts for 2 years. And they were constant attendees. Among the ones who were constant attendees vs. the ones that didn't attend Cub Scouts at all, the Cub Scouts improved on all six metrics if they had attended consistently, Cub Scouts for those 2 years, vs. the boys that did not attend Cub Scouts, which either made no improvement, reversed or had very slight improvement during those 2 years.
- 5.52** The other is Boy Scouts. And Boy Scouts have gotten a lot of bad PR lately in many respects for good reasons, for molestations, which are not okay, obviously. And so that's scared many people away from Cub Scouts. So I have a different translation for that, which is, yes, pay more attention to who the leaders are. Yes, talk to your son about it and pick up hints. And if you have any suspicions at all, get involved to a

greater degree, or if you're a dad or a stepdad, get involved as a leader yourself in the Cub Scouts so you'll know what's going on and you could potentially be one of the people that helps guide your sons. But did I just say Cub Scouts? I meant Boy Scouts, but Boy Scouts are— I talk about this in The Boy Crisis book—have deconstructed masculinity, I don't know whether it's conscious or unconscious, better than any group that I know. Meaning that boys are very responsive to being given honors and rewards. You saw the social bribes discussion that I have. We're just given a medal and we're willing to die. But the Cub Scouts rewards are very much oriented toward, like, merit badges. So the boy feels like, "If I do this, I have a merit badge."

- 5.53** But there's a trick that almost nobody ever points out about Boy Scouts, that usually those merit badges have a male mentor to help the boy get the merit badge, to guide the boy through the process. So you're getting a surrogate dad in addition to a reward for the boy accomplishing something which does not get given—hence boundary enforcement— without accomplishing and disciplining and having postponed gratification, many of the gifts of a dad. And so then when a boy has gotten used to getting a merit badge for something, he also wants to have something bigger that those merit badges lead to. And so part of the deconstruction of masculinity that the Boy Scouts have done is to then have, when you get 5 of those merit badges, you become a Star Scout. And if you get 10 of them, you become a Life Scout. If you get 21 of them, you become an Eagle Scout.
- 5.54** The boy has always an immediate aspiration and a long term postponed gratification, aspiration and a comparison to other boys that he can compete with and feel good about. And all of those things inspire the boys to have the discipline, the focus, and then a mentor at each one of those merit badges and acknowledgement when he does achieve from the outside, the outside being both peers and the troop leaders, and the single mom, if he's the son of a single mom. So one of the best surrogate dads is Cub Scouts and Boy Scouts.
- 5.55** It's also rites of passage organizations. Rites of passage organizations, like, probably the biggest one in the country is the ManKind Project—MKP. Very much around chapters in many places in the country. So if you know a mom who's looking for a rites of passage organization, that's probably among the best. There's places like the Young Men's Ultimate Weekends. There's places like Boyz II Men that help to nurture boys, particularly ones oftentimes that have committed crimes or have had run into trouble or have dropped out of school. Oftentimes boys who do not have that involvement, these organizations are very helpful.
- 5.56** A rite of passage can turn a boy around. It can help him move from thinking of himself this way to thinking of himself as a man, it can help him sort of say, "Okay, now I'm in a different part of myself. I need to take responsibility part of myself," as opposed to, "I need to just whine and beg for things." That's the good news. But it's not a full

substitute for having what I would call a rite of passage every day of one's life of an involved and loving dad.

- 5.57** When we have a dad involved with boys, it's oftentimes, it prepares boys for the caring professions. Asking for dad involvement encourages young men to be, to think of themselves as caring beings and therefore prepare themselves for all the caring professions that we talked about yesterday. I was talking about MFTs, MSWs, I talked about physicians' assistants, all of these things. The healthcare industry is going to blossom and open up all over the developed world, and particularly in the United States. That has been very challenged in the caring profession area. And so there's going to be a lot of purpose opportunities in there.
- 5.58** Physicians' assistants make very good money, and these professions that I'm mentioning in the caring professions, I'm not talking about becoming MDs. Remember the data yesterday? We saw how many fewer boys were getting bachelor's degrees, master's degrees, and doctorates. So let's look at caring professions as professions that do not require you being a PhD or an MD or being a lawyer or whatever, but ones that require less education, which men are increasingly less prone toward doing.
- 5.59** It may be something that a boy who's being brought up by a single mom, who oftentimes tends to be more sensitive and therefore more in touch with his, more in touch with his feelings than boys brought up by single dads. And so caring professions may be a sense of purpose and a sense of purpose that's in alignment with him maybe not being motivated to compete so much, but in alignment with him having a sense of purpose as a result of caring. And so these are popping up all over. Nurse practitioners. If he's single, traveling nurses. If he's not single, I don't advise being a traveling nurse. And so these are all things for you to be looking at, to introduce your son to, take him to hospitals, take him to places where these people exist, have him talk to nurse practitioners, have him open his eyes to the possibility that caring can be part of him being a pioneer in the future of masculinity. That the future of masculinity is not just divorcing oneself from love and proving oneself worthy by working. It also incorporates work into caring and that he can be valued, loved, respected by doing caring. That's the future.
- 5.60** I mentioned about reviving recess before. We mentioned as part of the problem was the absence of recess. Now I want to talk for a moment about reviving recess. The Center for Disease Control, Centers for Disease Control, did a study of recess versus studying in terms of which created more opportunity for children to do better at work. Until recently, that question wasn't even in the minds of anybody. That, "What? Recess was considered time away from studying and therefore neglect of homework and neglect of being able to do well in a test." When the CDC had the guts to actually ask whether that was true or not, they found out that once you've studied sort of a base amount, that beyond that, every minute spent in recess actually led to the children

doing better than those additional minutes studying. And that was really surprising to pretty much everybody, but not so surprising that they didn't ask that question.

- 5.61** I saw this myself at a school in New York called Urban Dove. URBAN Dove. The Urban Dove School took in boys and girls, who had either already failed out of high school, or alternatively, they were marked by the school as being right on the edge of failure. Every single one of them, in order to get into the school, had to be predicted to never graduate high school. And so they decided to try something new, which was to take the first 2 hours of school each day for both the boys and the girls, and to give the boys and girls the requirement to be involved physically in sports and the types of 3 dimensions of liberal arts of sports that I talked about, basketball and different games, to do weights, to do sports that required discipline, sports that required competition, but they all required an opponent, something that was opposite. You couldn't lift those weights, you couldn't win against the other team.
- 5.62** And so then at the end of those 2 hours, the coaches no longer coached different groups that came in for the coaches. The coaches took off and were available to be with those students when they were having problems, let's say, in algebra. And the student didn't really want to get into algebra, but the coach then, if called upon, would come into the classroom and say, "Remember how you beat the opponent and you didn't think you could do it? This equation is the opponent and you can do it. You did it when you didn't think you could do it before." And it gave those boys the— remember we talked about the bond, when a boy has a bond created? And the coaches had created a bond with these boys and girls and came into the classroom and helped the boys and girls to sort of cash in on that bond by saying, "You can work with me. I'm here for you. Remember how I taught you to win in the past? You can do this in the same type of way."
- 5.63** 85%, I think it is, if I'm remembering correctly, 85% of those kids graduated from high school. Almost all the ones that graduated either went on to a community college, a regular college, or a vocational school. And their life obviously turned around very, very significantly from what it was expected to do when they were admitted to that school.
- 5.64** To help that process, we need to, solutions-wise, take what we found was part of the problem, which was neglecting and dropping vocational education, and reviving vocational education. In Japan, about 20-25% of all students enroll in vocational education. Almost all of them graduate. Of the ones that graduate, 99.5% of them get jobs pretty immediately after graduation. The difference between a boy getting a job vs. A boy dropping out of high school is enormous.
- 5.65** We have basically focused on college, and obviously with a PhD, I like college and like learning that way. But for many boys, that's not their style. And yet we make them losers because it isn't their style, when in fact, they have an enormous amount. I helped bring up a young man in my neighborhood, and his father wrote me about 2 years ago and said, "I'm so disappointed in my son because he's just becoming a

plumber." And I wrote him back and I said, "Plumbers make more than \$100,000 a year. He can start his own business. He's a very bright boy. Reward him for being a plumber, honor him for being a plumber." And he did do that. And he wrote back to me and said, "Thank you, Warren." We need to start honoring boys for doing the types of things that we didn't in past think of as what was the top of the prestige ladder for a young man.

- 5.66** We talked about video games and the problems that they cause. But I also talked in the problem section about video games in moderation vs. video games taken to the extreme like most boys do. I mentioned that boys typically play 13 hours of video games a week, and that that moves toward the addiction level, whereas 5, 6, 7 hours of video games, that is, video games in moderation, actually is usually very helpful for boys and girls both. And so I always think of video games as like red wine—a little bit really good and too much a problem. And some parents will say to me, "Well, I can't get my kids to stop playing video games." Whenever I hear something like that, or, "I can't get my kids to not bring electronics to the table." Whenever I hear that, what I know is one thing, the parents are not parents. The kids are the parents, and the parents are the child. There's lots and lots of ways of getting your kids not to bring the electronics to the table.
- 5.67** When I hear that, I have the parents make a list of all the types of things that they have to offer their children that they can stop offering to their children if they don't stop bringing video games to the table at any given night. And some of those things are, "Do you want a ride to your friend's house? Do you want a dessert? Do you want to have an opportunity to play, roughhouse? And all the gifts that we give children. There are dozens and dozens of gifts. "Do you want your favorite meal, as opposed to the ones that we can give you if you do bring the video games to the table?"
- 5.68** So that many times, parents who say things like, "I can't get my kids to stop bringing video games to the table," or not video games, but electronics to the table, they're letting their kids be in charge of them without understanding how much they offer to their kids. And it's amazing how much work I have to do sometimes just to get a parent to start listing all the things that they have to offer, all the things that they can use as leverage. They have taken it for granted as much as the child has taken it for granted.
- 5.69** I remember one parent coming to me and saying, "Well, he plays video games, but he plays it behind the closed door in his room." "What about opening the door?" "Oh, he likes the door closed." "He likes the door closed," does not have to rule. The door can be open." "Well, I did leave the door open, but he just turns the video games on from video games to something that he looks like he's what's supposed to be done so quickly that I can't keep up with it." "Yes, you can keep up with it. You can take his computer and you can bring it into the kitchen, the living room, or the dining room where you can keep an eye on it." "Oh, my God. I didn't even think of that. I would never do that. I

couldn't do that. He would not agree. He wouldn't want me to do that." Again, who's in control?

5.70 One of the most important types of parenting that I work on a great deal in my couples' communication course is what I call "checks and balance" parenting. And for me, this is such a fun slide that I—actually PowerPoint—that I actually have this illustration in The Boy Crisis book. As the dad sees the child being tossed into the air. It's just a little bit and very safe. As the child sees it. Oh, man, it's fun. As the mom sees it, it's a potential crime. And what is the right answer? The right answer is talking about how the mom sees it, how the dad sees it, discussing what the mom and dad feel about it, and beginning to work as what the positives are of each thing, and what type of safety mechanisms need to be added to if the child falls. There's no right answer. The right answer is really important communication about that.

5.71 One of the most important things that I want to be talking about is the family dinner night. There are many solutions on the communications level I talk about in The Boy Crisis book. This one is, "how to create family dinner nights without creating family dinner nightmares". And so everybody knows that it's helpful to have a family dinner night, but some of them turn into family dinner nightmares, and it's debatable how healthy it was to have them. So aside from electronics not coming to the table in family dinner nights, which we just dealt with, in addition to that, there's a lot of things that are parameters for a good family dinner night. And at the beginning of the most important communication.

5.72 Number one is that everybody has a chance to talk and nobody is interrupted. And when everybody has a chance to talk, before we move on from that person having a chance to talk, what that person says is shared by at least one of the other family members. And you rotate family members who are responsible for sharing what they heard the parent or the other sibling say. And when the other sibling says, "Well, what I heard you say was this," and then asks the question, "Did I distort anything?" And the brother or the sister, let's say, says, "Yeah, you distorted this." And then the brother or sister that just said what I heard you say says, "No, I didn't." That's not okay. There's no argument with the belief that the person who was talking always has the right to say something felt distorted to them until the person who was listening clarifies it enough to get it exactly the way that left the person talking feel undistorted and understood. And then after that, you ask that person to say, "Did I miss anything?" So they didn't have to just skip over something. And the same rule applies. The sibling or the parent or the child work at it until the person who was talking felt that nothing was missed. So you're teaching every child and every parent to be able to hear everybody else at the table

5.73 Normally speaking, let's say the child is speaking and is saying, "Oh, man, I had a lot of fun with Jimmy." And the parents remember, "Wait a minute. Isn't Jimmy the one that was expelled from school? I don't want you hanging out with Jimmy. Isn't Jimmy the

one that talks about his mother this way? Isn't Jimmy the one that..." And so the child talking detects body language that basically says, "Shut up because I don't want to get into trouble." So oftentimes parents will tell me, "I asked my kids, 'How did things go in school?' And the kids go, 'Oh, okay.' It's like trying to drag something out of them." But an hour later, they hear that same child talk to a friend on the phone and go on for a half hour, practically nonstop, about what was going on in school. The difference is that the expectation on the phone call with the peer is that there'll be empathy. There'll be sort of a common experience shared, that there won't be a sort of lecture in judgment. So the child has the invitation to open up.

5.74 That said, empathy is a very tricky phenomenon. Kids who are constantly empathized with and only empathized with by parents do not become empathetic children. If the only way empathy is going is from the parents to the children, empathy as a one-way street leads to children being self-centered because it's only their feelings that are being thought of. Part of a successful family dinner night is that the empathy goes every way. It goes to the child and from the child to each sibling and from the child to the parent, when it's the parent's time to talk. And the child is required to say, "What I heard you say... Did I distort anything? Did I miss anything?" Until the child gets what the parents are feeling, and there's no requirement for the parents and the children or the children and the siblings to think, have the same picture of reality. There's an acceptance that—as I was talking about before, and that 4 artists portraying one person at the exact same moment, that's the type of framework you want to set up for a family dinner night. All of this is outlined, and this is so important that I just made a separate appendix of this in *The Boy Crisis* book, because this is really the beginning of training your children to be good communicators.

5.75 The only downside is when your children learn to hear other people in this way, to make sure that they haven't distorted and they haven't missed anything, they end up with too many friends because everybody wants to be heard in this way.

Lecture 6: Courageous Love

At a glance — Courageous love, drawing on Farrell's couples' communication work, and its lessons for raising and connecting with boys.

- 6.1** One of the things that I do with the other half of my life is do couples' communication workshops. And I think it's, from my perspective, it's the most important work that I do. At the core of what inspired me to do this was I got a letter from—I had been doing couples' communication as 1/5 of my workshops on "Why Men Are the Way They Are" or "Women Can't Hear What Men Don't Say", books like that. And some guy writes me afterwards and says, "That part of the workshop that you did on couples' communication, that really was so helpful to me that I'm using it for my family business." And then he signed it as the CEO of Walmart. So it's sort of a big family business. And I thought if he could hire any consultant in the world, and this was helpful to him, that maybe I had had in the back of my mind, a lot of other things that I felt I needed to do with this work. I discovered something that I didn't know whether I could solve the problem or not, but I thought I could.
- 6.2** And so the problem was that I was found that the Achilles heel of human beings was our inability to handle personal criticism without becoming defensive. And I saw that historically speaking and biologically speaking, that was biologically natural. That is, if you got criticism, it was a potential enemy. And we see when China or somebody is criticizing us a lot today, we fear that maybe that's going to lead to an escalation and possibly war. So it made sense as when we're criticized, to get up our defenses, because to make sure that we're not vulnerable to that enemy. Or alternatively, to kill the enemy before the enemy kills us. And that was very functional for survival. It's just totally dysfunctional for intimacy and totally dysfunctional for love.
- 6.3** So the question that I had to deal with was that I saw that the closest thing that we had come to that, in couples' communication, was active listening. But the problem was that active listening was never done outside of a therapist being present. And so I asked myself, "Why is that?" And what I concluded was that active listening is very safe and very good for the person who is the criticizer, because the criticizer gets listened to. But the natural biological defense that every human being wants when they're criticized was being, the person being criticized was not allowed to use that defense. And then worse yet, they had to repeat the criticism without the defense. So it was felt to the person being criticized, like double jeopardy. And so therefore, nobody did it independent of a therapist being available. That meant it was only available, in a sense, to people who could afford a therapist. That didn't feel really good to me.
- 6.4** And so I started asking myself, "Is there a way around that? And is there a way that we can provide a safe environment for somebody to handle personal criticism so that while the criticism was being given, they actually felt it was an opportunity to be more deeply loved?" That was my goal. So that instead of having a natural biological response of

defensiveness, they had a modified response, not biological, of associating that with an opportunity to be loved.

6.5 So I started working on that. And one of the things that I worked on was that it wasn't really possible until you altered your naturally biological, defensive self. So the question was, "How do you alter that?" So I have people alter that by meditating into six mindsets before they hear criticism and setting up the week outside of the time when they hear this criticism as a conflict-free zone and teaching them how to maintain it as a conflict-free zone through a number of other techniques.

6.6 But the core was having this skill set to be able to handle criticism to begin with. And so I had everybody in the group sit back-to-back with their partner. And I remember this is a couples' communication workshop. About 1/3 of the people there, this is their last try. If this fails, we've seen every psychologist possible, every couples' communication person possible. If this fails, we're out of here. We're on our way. But despite that, by about 1/3 of the workshop, another 1/3 of the workshop was there for enhancement, and the other was somewhere in between.

6.7 And so despite that, I would ask each person to sit back-to-back with their partner and to write on a piece of paper the answer to the following question. And the question was, "If you imagined your partner was about to be killed and you knew with 100% certainty that you could save your partner's life, but that you would have a 50% chance of risking your own life in the process, a 50% chance of dying in the process, would you do it? — Eliminate children as a factor." And so with the elimination of children as a factor, I gave them the choices of saying, "yes, no, maybe." And then I asked the second question, "If you wouldn't be willing to give up your life to risk your life at that level, would you be willing to risk losing a limb like an arm or a leg, but with 100% guarantee that you could save your partner's life?" So then all the men wrinkled up the paper in a real tight ball and threw it one side of the room. All the women threw it on another side of the room, if there were two women or two men, I worked that out a little differently. And then from that, they all read the answers.

6.8 And about 90% of the men said that they would be willing to risk dying to save their partner's life. And about 82-83% of the women said they'd be willing to risk their life, dying. And so people got into a little discussion about men, women, and stuff like that. But the amazing thing to me was that 80% to 90% of the people in the room were willing to risk their life. Another group was willing to not risk their life, but to risk losing an arm or a leg. One or two people were just willing to lose an ice cream cone. But for the most part, and so that was really informative and also quite shocking.

6.9 And so the first meditation was before they listened to their partner's criticism. "If I would lose my life to save my partner's life, maybe I can listen to my partner to give her life or to give him life, because when you're listened to, you do get life. And so suddenly, that dramatic propensity to respond defensively to criticism, they were altering their natural biological response. And then a second meditation, and this will

be the only other one I'll give you, is that the second meditation would be, "If I can provide a safe environment for my partner's feelings, no matter what my partner says and no matter how my partner says it or what they exaggerate or don't, if I can provide a safe environment for my partner's feelings under those circumstances, my partner will feel more secure with me and therefore more loved by me, and therefore more love for me. How can I lose? Isn't that what I want? Isn't the fear of being criticized that my partner will love me less?" So they're meditating into an altered state.

- 6.10** And the promise is that when criticisms come up, if they escalate back and forth from more than two levels, that you visualize being able to take the criticism to this, what I call a "caring and sharing session", which I ask the couples to commit to once per week. And during that caring and sharing session, they visualize, "At the caring and sharing session, I have 100% likelihood of being heard. If I argue back and forth to my partner again, I have about 100% chance of this argument escalating and getting worse. And so what do I choose? What is better in my self interest to do?" And so I work with the couples with all sorts of ways of maintaining that conflict-free zone.
- 6.11** But that gives you a little sense of that the atmosphere is created not to tell couples wisdoms, because the problem with—and I do share things that I hope are wisdoms to create a foundation of love for each other—but the problem with wisdom is that wisdom disappears when criticism appears. Criticism is like an earthquake. The wisdom can build a foundation, but the foundation cannot be so strong that it isn't destroyed or significantly damaged by the earthquake of a criticism from someone we love.
- 6.12** And so that's sort of a little bit of the complexity of the next, what I call "evolutionary shift", and being able to move from a natural biological propensity to be defensive to a new shift into a temporary altered state, with the understanding that that altered state, depending on the person, usually only lasts between 25 minutes and an hour. And so every time you are re-criticized again, you have to prepare for that by altering your criticisms again.
- 6.13** About a year ago, I got a call from somebody named Chris Sprowls, who was at that time the Speaker of the House of Florida. He said, just wanted to let you know that I got a hold of your Boy Crisis book, and I used it with my three sons. My wife and I used it with our three sons. It really was so helpful to us that we gave it to the heads of the Republican and Democratic Family Committee in charge of family issues. And they read it, used it, and they drew up from that a bill, two bills, actually. One was a bill to allocate money to inspire fathers to be more involved and to create fatherhood as a women's issue, which I'll explain more in a moment. And then we also created a bill for equal shared parenting. Both bills passed the House and the Senate. But the amazing thing was about the bill to inspire fathers to be more involved was that it was passed unanimously by every Republican and every Democrat in the House. In this day and age, that was, like, mind-boggling.

- 6.14** I've almost never heard of anything got passed by all the Republicans and all the Democrats in the House. And I have to tell you, that made me very happy. And then he said, the second law for the requirement for equal shared parenting as long as there as the starting assumption also passed the House and the Senate. And then just recently, he said Governor DeSantis signed the bill creating \$70 million to inspire fathers to be more involved and to tell them how they were needed and to make sure that the constituencies knew it was a woman's issue as well, to have the overwhelm that almost all single mothers feel.
- 6.15** Before when I met my wife, I had been single for a while before that, and she used the word overwhelmed. And every single mother that I dated in the years before, every single single mother used the word overwhelmed. From my perspective, the involvement of fathers is a woman's issue, because there's no functional way—that is functional for a woman— to feel overwhelmed, but oftentimes feeling like, "I'm juggling my work life and I'm juggling my children, and I feel I'm not doing my work as well as I'm capable of doing. I'm not doing the job with my children that I'm capable of feeling guilty and feeling like a juggling act." And so, alternatively, this is really very much a woman's issue as well. And so we need to make sure that it's explained in that way. And so that's sort of the way I guess we got it to be explained in the House and then the Senate. And fortunately, Governor DeSantis signed that bill of allocating \$70 million to help inspire fathers to be more involved into law.
- 6.16** Unfortunately, he got a lot of negative feedback from the American Bar Association on the Domestic Violence aspects of the feminist movement and gave into that and did not sign the Equal Shared Parenting bill into law. And so I'm sad about that, but at least it was one step in the right direction.
- 6.17** The value of having fathers be inspired, and mothers seeing it as a woman's issue is that it builds the political base to counter the American Bar Association. The American Bar Association, every state except for Kentucky, where it was overwhelmed—the American Bar Association has been an opponent of equal shared parenting because basically a lot of their money is made from working on divorce issues and combating in court.
- 6.18** One of the things that I've discovered in my research is that there are 4 must-dos after divorce. And this is like years of research boiled down into 4 must-dos. So the 1st must-do is equal shared parenting. We have enormous data now that's published in scientific journals saying that when children have, after divorce, less than 40% involvement with either parent, that they don't do nearly as well as they do when they have 50% or anything more than 40%. And so, as you go above 40% involvement and get to 50%, the closer you get to 50%, the better on average the children do. Not just the boys, but also the girls. Difference between the boys and the girls is that the boys tend to have a bigger percentage of positive outcome, but both boys and girls have a more positive outcome.

- 6.19** Some of the positive outcomes are a little different. Girls with minimal amount of father involvement are much more likely to become pregnant without being married, while they're teenagers. They're much more likely to feel that the only way that they know a male and how to keep that male, as opposed to another female, getting that male that she really likes— the only way to keep him that she knows about for sure is to be sexual with him, so she doesn't calculate or think inside of herself, "Am I ready to be sexual with this man?" She says, "Okay, I want to keep him, therefore, I'll be sexual as a way of keeping him." That's obviously dysfunctional and can also lead to the out-of-wedlock pregnancy.
- 6.20** Conversely, she's so uncomfortable with a male that she's afraid to get into relationship with a male because she doesn't know how to do it, and it feels uncomfortable, feels like she's going to mess it up, feels like she's going to be rejected. Sex-wise, she isn't ready to open up and trust because she doesn't really know how to trust a male. And so those are some of the differences. But for almost everything else, both the males and the females benefit differently.
- 6.21** One of the amazing studies that takes a little bit more science behind it—when boys and girls are 9 1/2 years old, you're able to predict how long they are going to live by the length of their telomeres. When they're 9 years old, telomeres are little subcells in your body that allow you to have the ability to connect with things that heal your body or things that do not heal your body. And they're very good predictors of how long you will live. When boys and girls are 9 1/2 years of age, which is one of the best ages for that prediction, the ones that have father involvement, have a 14% longer life expectancy based on the telomere lengths, than those that don't. However, boys' life expectancy and telomere lengths are then again, either 40% longer if their fathers are involved or 40% shorter if their fathers are not involved. So it gives you a sense of the enormous biological impact—things that we've never even known about. We often think that moms have this natural tendency of a motherhood instinct, and that is true. That is actually what does happen in the brain of a mother when a child is born.
- 6.22** But what has not been discussed, ever, that I've ever seen, is that when a child is born and the father perceives himself as desirous of being involved with the child, and on a contact level, that his brain changes. It changes even for the father that doesn't interpret the birth of the child that way, but it changes much more when the father perceives that the birth of that child means a lot of involvement on his part. Neurons connect in the brain in such a way that it actually activates the dormant part of the brain that I call the dad brain. And it's a parallel brain to the motherhood instinct development. It's not exactly the same, but it is very similar to different in the sense that different things emerge from the dad as part of the contributions that we've just talked about vs. the moms.
- 6.23** But the father begins to have an investment in being more involved. His testosterone gets lower. A lot of other things happen to his hormones as well. So we've discussed

the motherhood instinct for generations, but most of us have not even known, and we certainly don't see headlines about dads' brains changing when they get involved with their children. So that's one of the reasons for equal shared parenting being so important. And some of the psychology, by not understanding the dad brain, by not understanding telomere benefits, we don't have the political will to make that happen yet.

- 6.24** The 2nd is that there be a maximum of 20 minutes drive time between mother and father if there's a divorce. So when there's too great a drive time between mom and dad after a divorce, the child begins to resent going to the other parent's house because they're missing activities at school, like playing soccer, activities that help their growth, or they're missing their best friend's birthday party, and they start resenting going to the other parent's home. And so the farther away the other parent lives, the more challenge that tends to be. So maximum 20 minutes drive time after divorce is really helpful for the children.
- 6.25** Third is something I talked about earlier today, is no badmouthing, no badmouthing Dad to Mom, no badmouthing Mom to Dad for all the reasons I mentioned earlier, that the child is half the mom and the child is half the dad. When that child looks in the mirror and sees a parent badmouth, it also feels that it has been badmouthed, but doesn't have the permission to open up and express feelings about it, for fear will only make the stabilization of his or her family life worse than it was before.
- 6.26** And fourth is couples' communication. This is the most recent finding—which is done by both at the University of California and an East Coast university, I think it was Harvard—and that has been found to be important to be not just couples' communication on emergency basis. When there's an emergency and a couple goes to a counselor and reports how each one feels about the emergency, the short amount of time that an emergency provides, the short amount of time leads to oftentimes arguments and fights, but not an understanding of the best intent of the partner. Whereas if you have consistent couples' communication counseling without an emergency, there's a chance for a good therapist to be able to facilitate understanding, "Well, the mom feels this way because..." "The dad feels this way because..." And to work it out and have both of them begin to listen to each other. And so those are the four must -dos after divorce that I have found to be the most essential.
- 6.27** Here is rowing the family boat, but it's a metaphor for the solution to this issue. In the past, mothers learned to row the family boat only from the left side, which symbolically would mean raising children, and dads learn to row the family boat only from the right side, raising money. But in the last half- century, many women have learned to row the boat from both the left and the right side. The problem is if the woman can row the boat from either the left or the right side and the man can only row the boat from the raising money side, the boat goes in circles and it allows no one the flexibility that

everybody needs in a family where technology will be changing careers and forcing us to adapt constantly.

- 6.28** So the old system of women raise children, men raise money, is fine as an option, but if both sexes don't know how to do both behaviors, then that's really damaging to the potential flexibility that can be provided to the family by both knowing both.
- 6.29** So we'll move from the personal to the political, and we'll go back to the personal again in just a moment. I chair a coalition to create a White House Council on Boys and Men. And I started this when, about eleven years ago when President Obama formed a White House Council on Women and Girls, and I got asked to be on the board of advisor of the White House Council on Women and Girls. And I said, "I'd be happy to be on the board of advisors of the White House Council on Women and Girls given my background with NOW, but there's also a need for a White House Council on Boys and Men." And the woman said, "Well, gee, I'm only in charge of building up the advisory board for this. I'm not able to authorize a new council, but if you draw up a proposal for it, I'll help make that happen. I'll tell you where to guide it through the administration."
- 6.30** So I spent a little bit over a year, getting together what I thought were the best thought leaders in the country to draw up a proposal to create a White House Council for Boys and Men. We got that approved officially by the Boy Scouts of America. And we decided, rather than send me to represent the coalition, it would be better to send an Eagle Scout along with the Boy Scouts, because the Boy Scouts had a yearly meeting set up already with President Obama and most presidents. And so we organized all of that. The group got outside of the Oval Office with an appointment with President Obama, and at the last minute, Valerie Jarrett came up and approved of every single thing on the agenda and crossed out the suggestion for the proposal to create a White House Council on Boys and Men. Said it wasn't the right time for it, but as it turned out, there was no time that was the right time for it. Long story short.
- 6.31** And then President Trump eliminated the council, basically made it de funct. The White House Council on Women and Girls. And then we went to the next president, President Biden. And he created something I was just delighted about at first, called the White House Gender Policy Council, which was perfect alignment with his promise of diversity, equity, and inclusion, which would then be not just one gender, but both genders. There was just one problem with it. It didn't include men, and it didn't include boys.
- 6.32** So I contacted the chair of the council and I said, "This is outrageous. Your motto that you became president, that President Biden became president on, was diversity. Where does the word diversity not include men? Equity, inclusion. This is excluding boys and men. How is that inclusion? And you are in favor of diversity that includes blacks and includes gay people, but the blacks include black males, and you're including any attention to all males that happens to include black males and Hispanic males, and you're in favor of gay relationships as a possibility, but this includes all gay males. So

what is there about diversity or equity or inclusion that is included in the Gender Policy Council?" And there was, the response that I got from this is from Jennifer Klein, the head of the council, she said, "Oh, we care a lot about fathers and men." "Well, so then include them." "Well, no, no. President Biden is very much in favor of fathers, and he's a very good father himself." "That's fine, then include them." But it got nowhere.

- 6.33 And so we made many political attempts to make that happen, but it has been just 100% unsuccessful at this point in time. But just to give you a sense of how in the culture, this is so deep and permeated that nothing about this has become part of the federal government. As an example, under both Republican and Democratic administrations, there have evolved 7 federal Offices of Women's Health. Now, and 0 federal offices of men's health or boys health. Now the astonishing thing about this is that men die sooner of 14 out of 15 of the leading causes of death. And that we saw in the first slide about the evidence that the life expectancy gap has grown from one year in 1920 to 5.3 years in 2021.
- 6.34 Despite all this, men dying sooner of 14 out of 15 of the leading causes of death, there's no Office of Men's Health and 7 Offices of Women's Health. So this is why this is a personal issue. It is a community issue. It is an issue with our schools about recess and vocational education, but it's also an issue that has to be thought of and applied to the federal government as well.
- 6.35 My perspective—in the future, I believe we don't need a women's movement making men into the oppressors or blaming men. And we certainly don't need a men's movement criticizing women and making themselves right. We need what I would call a gender liberation movement, liberating both sexes from the rigid roles that were functional in the past to much more flexible roles that will be functional in the future. We need to look ahead and recognize that the shift to more flexible roles is something that both sexes benefit from.
- 6.36 That doesn't mean any one sex has to do, or any one person has to do anything different than is natural for them, but that that availability to do things different without being shamed or ostracized or being illegal is available to both sexes. Just as our daughters have learned in the last half-century to discover, to have their unique self discovered by their parents. So our sons need to have their unique self discovered by their parents and by permission from society to discover it.
- 6.37 In that process, boys and men, just like women and girls, get real power. Real power is not climbing up some ladder, losing yourself as a human doing— losing yourself as a human being in exchange for becoming a human doing. Real power is discovering who you are and being able to pursue and control your own life, to be able to become who you are as a human being.
- 6.38 One of the ways of doing this is by joining a boys' or men's group. I said before that I've formed about 300 boys and men's groups. And they've really been a very helpful way of

getting boys to go from learning a method of communication in which they sort of talk about their strengths and prepare themselves to kill and be killed. And this is preparation for boys to also learn how to love and be loved.

6.39 And in boys' and men's groups, there's so many things that come up that once I started to listen to the boys and men, as opposed to give them feminist lectures, as I talked about the other day, I started seeing so many boys and men open up and become different human beings. Their brotherhood went from that brotherhood of supporting each other to kill, that Stephen Crane—we talked about yesterday, that was with the Marines, etc.—it transfers from a brotherhood of kill and be killed to a brotherhood of learning how to open up and express feelings and love and be loved. And so the examples of the types of things that we discuss in that group are things like, "What's the glint in your eye? What's the biggest hole in your heart? What's an argument I got into with my girlfriend?"

6.40 And oftentimes when girls and women get together, they interpret a woman saying what argument they got into with their boyfriend as a mandate to support the woman emotionally. Guys are problem solvers. When men get into talk about problems that they had with their girlfriend, every guy gathers together and says what they could have done differently. That's the male propensity. "Solve the problem and don't complain!" We men reinforce that with each other, and, "There's something wrong with you if you won't be willing to solve that problem and do it differently." So men's groups are very different that way in that respect with women's groups. But both men's and women's groups facilitate the opening up of feelings that are inside. And oftentimes, once women go through being supported by being told how bad the guy is, and that's all out, then they come back to more constructive types of ways without having to be confronted before they're ready to be confronted.

6.41 Men's groups will often talk about things like somebody who says in the men's groups, "I feel like I might be gay, but I'm afraid to admit it, even to this group, because I'm afraid that this group really will maybe not pay much attention to me in the group, not have any respect for me in the group. And then you guys sometimes go out together afterwards, and I notice you already don't invite me as much as you do Jimmy. You invite Joe. And I'm worried that that will happen even more if I do let myself get in touch with those feelings." And so the group almost always responds by saying that they'll value whoever that boy or young man is, and that frees him to be whoever he is.

6.42 So after forming these groups for years and writing for Ms. Magazine—which was the original feminist magazine that some of you probably have heard of or read about in your history books—I went to a big party celebrating—I think it was the 10th year or something like that—anniversary of Ms. Magazine. I had this arrangement to talk with Gloria Steinem afterwards, and so I was looking forward to that. And I made contact with her to sort of—eye contact with her—to sort of make sure that she remembered the appointment that she said she was going to have with me.

- 6.43 And on the way to that, sort of working my way through the crowd at this party to her, this guy comes up to me and he says, "You, Warren Farrell?" And I go, "Yeah." And he says, "I really wanted to meet you because you changed my life." And I go, "Well, how's that?" And he goes, "Well, you formed this men's group that I joined, but you had already left the men's group after you started it. You seem like the lone ranger. You start things, and then you just go off and leave them." And teasing me I started to respond a little defensively, and I saw the twinkle in his eye, and he was saying, "It's fine, and I really just appreciate you starting the group to begin with. It meant a lot to me." So I said, "Well, how did it mean so much to you?" And he said, "Well, as a result of the group, I took off years to take care of my child." And I said, "So how is that?"
- 6.44 Now he had my attention, and so I dropped my thinking about meeting Gloria, and I said, "Did that work out well?" And he said, "It worked out extremely well." I said, "Well, how did this come about?" And he said, "Well, one of the things you get your men's groups to do is to have a question saying, 'What's the biggest hole in your heart?' And when it got to me, I thought it was kind of a silly question, but when it got to me, I just blurted out that the biggest hole in my heart was being so involved with my business that I really never paid attention to my son, nor did I pay attention to my wife. And as a result of that, I ended up getting a divorce, and I rarely see my son. That was the hole in my heart." And I said a little bit inquisitively, "What's the trigger for this being the hole in your heart?" And he said, "Well, actually the trigger is that I'm remarried now and my wife is pregnant. And I found out that we're going to have a boy and so I'm afraid that I'm going to be doing the same thing again."
- 6.45 So I said, "You must be pretty active in your work." He says, "Yes, I probably work 24/7, and I shouldn't. I know that, but I do." And so I said, "Well, so how did this evolve?" And he goes, well, the group said to me, after I said what the hole in my heart was, they said, "Well, what would be your fantasy?" That's another Warren Farrell question, "What are your fantasies?" And he said, "So I shared my fantasy, which would be, I'd like to take 4 or 5 years off it and be fully focused on my son, because we know it's a boy, and I don't want to make the same mistake as I made the last time." And I said, "Well, great." I said, "Well, what did the men's group say?" And he said, the men's group said, "Have you checked with your wife about whether she'd be okay with that?" And he said, "I said, no, I haven't checked with her. I think it's really impractical, and I don't think she would be open to that, but maybe she would. I don't know. She's very much cooperative." And so the groups put the pressure on me and said, "Can you at least check with your wife about how she feels about that? Begin a discussion?"
- 6.46 And he said, "Well, I came back to the men's group of a couple of months later, and the discussion had evolved. And every single complexity that we had talked about was something that she went along with and basically said, 'I want you to do what you feel you want to do.'" I said, "Well, where did it go from there?" And he said, "Well, it went from there that I explained to the group that that was a really nice thing that they

encouraged me to do, but I have a lot of legal contracts, a lot of obligations. I can't possibly do that."

6.47 And so the group said, "John, do you own the business or does the business own you?" And he said, "That really set me back. And I realized that the answer was pretty damn clear. The business owns me. And then the group started talking that through with me, and I realized that I didn't want the business to own me, but that I had a lot of legal contracts that weren't just about my wants." And so the group said, "Well, have you heard of the word 'renegotiate'?" And he said, "Obviously, yes." "And so you can renegotiate the contracts, can't you?" And he said, "Well, maybe. Maybe some I can and maybe some I can't." He said, "Well, the group said to me, 'Well, you won't know until you try, right?'" And as it turned out, he said, "I had actually a lot of lawsuits against me and wasn't able to renegotiate them all." So I said, "Well, then, did you take off any time to take care of your children, your child, rather?" And he said, "Yes." And I said, "How long ago was that?" And he said, "About a year and a half ago." I said, "Was that a good decision?" And he said, "Warren, it was the best decision of my life." And I said to him, "Well, how so?"

6.48 He said, "Before, I always thought about love and talked about love, but I never realized that every moment I was bringing up my son, I was really experiencing love. I was seeing even things like what food to feed him or how to put his arm in one sleeve vs. the other. It was like things that I just never thought of as identifying in love and the type of love where I didn't expect anything back. I just loved giving, and that that gave me such a fulfillment that I never even was able to articulate before." And so as this happened, and he made it really clear that this was not a good decision. It was, as he put it, "The best decision of my life."

6.49 And as we were talking through this, it became—it was about an hour now of discussion—and somebody came up for me, to me, or to the table—and I had just come back from my first paperback book tour, and I'd been on TV a lot—and somebody came up and asked for an autograph. And I said, I immediately said, "Yes, thank you. Just a second." And got ready to take the pen and the paper that he was ready to give me. Sort of, I felt an awkwardness, and I said, "What's happening here?" And he said, "Oh, I would definitely like your autograph, but could I have his first?" And so this fellow I was sitting next to just quickly signed the autograph and gave it back to this guy.

6.50 And I said, "You signed that autograph like you've done it a hundred times before, and then I confess that I don't watch TV. Your name is John?" And he goes, "Yes." And I said, "Well, John who?" And he goes, "John Lennon." But he told me first he didn't want to tell me that it was anything because he liked it just the way it was. I wasn't self-conscious. He didn't have to worry about what he was saying. And it was all sort of in that type of mood, and he resisted telling me his full name. And I, who almost never watched TV, said—and I was proud of myself for being able to do this—I said to him,

"John Lennon, are you a singer?" And I was proud of myself for knowing that much. And he said, "Yes." I could see this bemused smile and in a way, a very happy smile on his face that I didn't know. And believe me, if I had known, I would have been very much more self-conscious. So it was a gift we both gave each other. And I said, "Are you with a group? Am I remembering correctly?" And he said, "Yes." And I said, "What's the name of the group?" And he goes, "The Beatles." Well, that much I knew. My level of ignorance had not gotten down that low, but that then, as soon as he said it was with the Beatles, I began to see that I was much more self-conscious than I had been before.

- 6.51** What I began to see was a couple of things. One is, interestingly, had John Lennon paid attention to his first son being born, we would never have heard of John Lennon. That he had made a choice that was dysfunctional for love, but it also created a very different phenomenon in life, a person with probably perhaps among the most envious careers in history. Second, it might have been easier for John Lennon to leave the career, to become a full-time dad because he had money, many people have told me. And in many ways, quite the opposite is true. If you don't have money, yes, that's a challenge. But if you do have money, you have all these legal obligations, all of these expectations. And what John acknowledged to me later is that I did feel guilty about disappointing billions of fans. Now, he had already been separated from the Beatles at this point, but he was structuring, and his contracts were with his solo career after he had separated from the Beatles.
- 6.52** And he said, "I did have billions of fans, and I didn't want to disappoint them." But then, as we talked further, he said, "And I guess I couldn't handle the fact that I wouldn't have billions of fans either." So that the dependency was quite mutual, the fans on him and him on the fans. And he said, "I guess I was most impacted by the groups saying, do you own the business, or does the business own you?" So here I disagree with John. Love is not all you need. And what allowed John to make that decision was a wife who cared more about him than money. The choice of your partner, whether you're gay or straight, is perhaps your most important career decision, as well as your most important life decision.
- 6.53** Number two, besides love, you need a pushy men's group or somebody who's ready to ask, to challenge you. The men's group was all very honored to have John Lennon as part of the men's group. If they became self-conscious and they became unwilling to confront, they would not have helped John be able to not be owned by his business. So that's also helpful. A cooperative wife and a pushy men's group. And also being able to identify the hole in your heart, being able to ask the question about, "What is bothering me?" that many, many men, especially, are afraid to ask for reasons we talked about yesterday.
- 6.54** Fourth is the ability to imagine. We all know about John Lennon's song Imagine. Well, in this case, he did have the ability to imagine. And fifth, the courage to execute. All of

that is needed in addition to the ability as a way to execute loving. So I think that my message to all of us is to give our son and our daughter the opportunity to be a pioneer in the evolutionary shift from defining self as a man, as a self that has to earn money in order to be a man, and make that evolutionary shift into somebody who defines themselves as the ability to love and to understand. The stepping stones, the courage, the disagreements you'll get, but have the imagination to be able to work out a plan of getting the right partner, getting the right ability to be facilitated in your feelings so that you're able to love. Thank you.